The Ontology of Coexistence

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The question: What is Existence? What exists? Does what exists begin at some time? Does the individual self (*jeevan*) begin or end with the body? Is the world finally real?

This study examines those questions in **Madhyasth Darshan** (Co-existentialism), as presented by **Shri A. Nagraj**, and compares its answers with **Advaita Vedanta** and selected **modern philosophical and scientific approaches** to physical reality, consciousness, and selfhood. Full treatment of time (*kaal*), *trikaalabadh*, and spacetime physics is in *Nature of Time*; here only the core claim is stated — that *kaal* is duration of unit-activity and *satta* is timeless as ground (§1.4).

Standpoint and scope

These studies are written from the standpoint of a **scientist and technologist** — someone trained to graduate-level **physics and mathematics**, at home with contemporary cosmology, quantum theory, conservation laws, and the logic of formal models.

From that background, a familiar picture of nature is hard to avoid: **consciousness appears as something the brain does** — an epiphenomenon, functional outcome, or emergent property of particular configurations of very large numbers of physical particles. Modern physics and cognitive science are powerful on mechanism, prediction, and public evidence; yet the hard problem of consciousness, the status of the self, and the reality of value remain fiercely contested. The standpoint taken here does not treat those gaps as settled in favour of matter-only reductionism.

The work begins where that scientific picture leaves open questions — and asks whether Madhyasth Darshan offers a coherent alternative worth examining seriously. The study reads the primary texts carefully, states what follows from the darshan itself, and compares it in parallel with what we know from **physics and the natural sciences**, **Advaita Vedanta**, and **modern Western philosophy** (especially philosophy of mind). Physics and mathematics are **one leg** of that comparison, not the only one. The aim is rigorous comparative understanding — testing definitions, internal consistency, and fit with public knowledge — not persuasion or devotional endorsement.

The study develops Madhyasth Darshan's ontology — saturation, causation, unit structure, the sentience threshold, and conservation — then compares it with Advaita Vedanta and selected modern views. It does not claim that physics, neuroscience, or comparative argument alone establish immortal *jeevan*, constitutional completeness, or continuity across bodily death. Where traditions use different criteria of knowing, the dispute is treated as partially incommensurable (§6.5); open points are collected in §6.2. These topical studies state the philosophy in clear, checkable prose first; a separate formal mathematical treatment may follow once the definitions are stable across the series.

Several claims the ontology depends on are argued fully elsewhere: the **full-knowability thesis** in *Knowledge, Knower, and Known* §1.11, and **post-death continuity and evidence** in §§1.12, 6.2.4, and §6.4. Ethics, society, spiritual practice, and the full *kaal* treatment are deferred to linked studies (*Nature of Time* and others). Institutional **self-governance**, *dharma-niti* / *rajya-niti*, public justice, and statutory social order belong in the planned study *Governance Justice and Undivided Society* and related social studies; How to Form Self-Sustaining Organizations applies the template in concrete assemblies — neither replaces the ontological account here. This paper states the full regulation ladder ontologically (§1.7), distinguishes law from justice (§1.10.1), and develops saturation through self-governance in §§1.7, 1.10; detailed assembly law, *dharma-niti*, and statutory social order are developed in the planned Governance study and applied templates. §1 can be read on its own; comparative conclusions that rest on those premises are marked where they arise.

Quick Glossary

Terms in §1

Term	Plain meaning
Coexistence (*saha-astitva*)	Reality as the pervasive ground (*satta*) and all units (*ikai*) inseparably present together — beginningless, without creation from nothing.
Satta (Omnipresence)	The formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming ground in which all units are saturated. Editorial Notes for translation conventions.
Unit (*ikai*)	A countable, bounded entity in nature — insentient (*jada*) or sentient (*chaitanya*).
Saturation (*samprikt*)	The ever-present bond in which each unit is soaked, submerged, and surrounded in Omnipresence; inherent energy and regulation belong **in** the unit.
Effort–motion–result (*shram–gati–parinam*)	The single inseparable triad in which all change appears (SB p. 58).
The four orders (*chaar avastha*)	Material, bio/pranic, animal, and knowledge/human — real developmental plateaus in nature.
Relationship (*sambandh*)	Definite mutuality with expectations predetermined toward completeness (MVD p. 62).

Term	Plain meaning
Law (ontological)	Orderliness and regulation read from saturation — universal across all four orders; not statutory command.
Jeevan	The sentient self: a constitutionally complete, immortal unit that works through the body.
Constitutional completeness (*gathanpurnata*)	When a developed atom integrates its required particles and crosses irreversibly into sentient *jeevan* (T1).
Development progression (*vikas-kram*)	Movement through the physicochemical complex until an atom reaches constitutional completeness and sentient *jeevan* appears.
Awakening progression (*jagriti-kram*)	Movement within constitutionally complete *jeevan* toward fuller activity and conduct.

Further terms — planes, justice, prosperity, *gyan* registers — are defined where they first appear in §1.

Terms in §2

Term	Plain meaning
Brahman	The sole absolute reality — being, consciousness, bliss (*sat-chit-ananda*), one without a second.
Paramartha	Absolute level of truth; Brahman alone is absolutely real.
Vyavahara	Shared empirical order — bodies, law, ethics, scripture; robust but sublated at highest realization.
Pratibhasika	Private apparent error (rope-snake, dream objects); sublated by correction.
Mithya	Dependent appearance — neither absolutely real nor sheer nothing; valid at *vyavahara*, sublated at *paramartha*.
Maya	Cosmic power of concealment (*avarana*) and projection (*vikshepa*); Ishvara's superimposition on Brahman.
Avidya	Individual ignorance — the jiva's superimposition of body-mind on the Self.
Adhyasa	Superimposition — attributing what belongs to one level to another (snake on rope).
Satkaryavada	The effect pre-exists in the cause (clay already in the pot).

Term	Plain meaning
Vivartavada	Apparent transformation — Brahman does not change; name-form is projected.
Upadhi	Limiting adjunct conditioning the Self (body, mind, sheaths).
Turiya	The "fourth" — witness-consciousness beyond waking, dream, and deep sleep.
Sakshin	Witness — the seer that is never itself an object of perception.
Moksha	Liberation — recognition of pre-existing identity with Brahman, not merger of a real individual.

Terms in §3

Term	Plain meaning
Physicalism	The view that every real, concrete phenomenon is physical — minds and selves are processes or organizations of physical systems.
Causal closure	Every physical event has a sufficient physical cause; no non-physical entity injects energy or intention into the physical order (Kim 2005).
Hard problem	Why and how physical processes give rise to subjective experience — the "something it is like" (Chalmers 1995; Nagel 1974).
Panpsychism	Experience is fundamental or ubiquitous in nature; wholly non-experiential matter cannot produce experience (Strawson 2006).
Combination problem	If micro-experientiality is primitive, how do micro-subjects combine into one unified macro-subject?
Illusionism	Phenomenal consciousness as usually conceived is a misdescription; only access-consciousness and functional states exist (Frankish 2016).
Personal identity	What makes a person the same individual over time — psychological continuity (Locke), reductionism (Parfit), or substance (soul, monad).
Scientific realism	The physical world exists mind-independently and is the proper object of public inquiry.
Neutral monism	Mind and matter are composed of a common neutral stuff, neither mental nor material in isolation (Russell 1921; Mach 1914).
Samadhanatmak bhautikvad	Resolution Centred Materialism — MD's reframing of materialism: real matter saturated in Omnipresence, not consciousness-from-matter or matter-only reduction (SB).

Terms in §4

Term	Plain meaning
Self-model	The brain's internal representation of the organism as a unified subject — not an immortal unit but a regulative construct (Metzinger 2003).
Predictive processing / active inference	The brain as a hierarchical generative model minimizing prediction error; selfhood as functionally real control structure (Friston 2010; Clark 2016).
Integrated information (Φ)	IIT's measure of how much a system's cause–effect structure is irreducible; consciousness tied to a structural threshold (Tononi 2012).
Autopoiesis	Living organization as a self-producing network maintaining its boundary through metabolism (Maturana and Varela 1980).
ΛCDM	Standard cosmological model: cold dark matter plus dark energy; hot big bang ~13.8 billion years ago.
Quantum field	In QFT, what persists are fields; particles are localized excitations, not tiny enduring substances (Weinberg 1995).
Brain death	Operational criterion for end of personhood in medicine — irreversible loss of whole-brain function.
Entropy	Thermodynamic tendency toward disorder in closed systems; distinct from MD's orderliness (*vyavastha*) at every order.
Natural selection	Differential reproduction of heritable traits; mainstream mechanism for biological adaptation and cooperation.

1. The Madhyasth Darshan Answer

Madhyasth Darshan defines **existence** as the ever-present **coexistence** of formless **Omnipresence** (*satta*) and countless bounded **units** of nature — beginningless, without creation from nothing, and indestructible at the level of being.

The account proceeds in layers. It begins with the two co-eternal poles and the bond of **saturation** between ground and units, then states what every unit is and how all change appears as **unit-activity**. It names the **four orders** of nature and the **relationships** in which units recognise and fulfil one another. From there it treats **regulation and law**, **composition** of larger units, and **development** toward sentience. The sentient self (*jeevan*), evaluative life, and knowledge in coexistence follow. The section closes with **conservation**, the **perpetual**

world, and what fulfilled human living evidences at the knowledge order. The full architecture is summarised in the figure at §1.9.

1.1 Coexistence: Omnipresence and units

Existence is **co-eternally present** as two inseparable poles: formless Omnipresence and formful units of nature — neither made from the other, neither ontologically prior. What changes is unit-activity, development, and awakening within coexistence. SB gives the most compressed formulation:

> **"What is evident is that consciousness and matter are inseparably present. Upon examining their fundamental nature, we learn that all of existence is essentially nature (matter) saturated in Omnipotence (consciousness). Here, 'seeing' is intended in the sense of understanding. Since nature saturated in Omnipotence is inseparably present, existence itself is eternally manifest in the form of coexistence."**
> *- SB, p. 48*

Editorial note: The translation prints **Omnipotence** for *satta* at this point; the study uses **Omnipresence** in analytical prose (Editorial Notes). The parenthetical "(consciousness)" labels the all-pervasive ground, not a personal knowing mind.

Realisation Knowledge (*anubhav jnan*) expresses this inseparable presentness:

> **"Sentient and insentient nature saturated in Omnipotence. The countless sentient and insentient units are saturated in Omnipotence (Omnipresence)."**
> *- MVD, p. 11*
>
> **"All units saturated in the Omnipresence (permeative and transparent) have form, properties, essential nature & dharma, and have inherent orderliness & participate in overall orderliness."**
> *- MVD, p. 11*

Existence thus has two inseparable aspects:

1. **Omnipresence (*Satta* / *Vyapak*):** The formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming, immeasurable reality. It is described as actionless energy (*kriya-shunya urja*): it performs no actions, yet its permeative presence is the ground through which units are energized, regulated, and conserved.

> **“Omnipotence is not confined within any dimension of length or breadth, nor can any measure be established for it; therefore, Omnipotence is all-pervasive.”**
> *- SB, p. 49*

2. **Units of nature:** The formful, active, countable, bounded entities — each with determinate reality.

> **“Nature, saturated in Omnipotence, exists as countless units. Each unit, being saturated in Omnipotence, remains surrounded, submerged, and soaked in it.”**
> *- SB, p. 48*

Nature names the saturated whole of formful existence; **units** are the countable entities within it — each bounded from six directions yet inseparably present in coexistence (MVD, pp. 11, 34).

Omnipotence is *sthitipurn* (**state-complete**) — eternally present without motion, wave, or pressure — while nature saturated in it is *sthitishil* (**state-dynamic**): the countless units whose activity, development, and awakening constitute all change (SB, pp. 50, 68–69). *Satta* does not progress; only unit-activity within saturation does.

1.2 Saturation: the ground–unit bond

The source describes units as soaked, submerged, and surrounded — *samprikt* — in Omnipresence. **Saturation** is the ever-present ontological bond between formless *satta* and each formful unit. Omnipresence does not act, transform, or be consumed in saturating a unit.

One way to picture the bond — **illustrative, not identity** — is a living cell in nutrient medium, or a sponge fully soaked in water: the unit remains surrounded, permeated, and sustained **through** the medium, not drained from a finite store. *Satta* is actionless (*kriya-shunya*), non-transforming, and not a physical substance that acts on units.

Through saturation, every unit has **inherent energy** and regulatory order **in** it:

> **“Every unit in its atomic state is active as orderliness, because it has inherent energy due to being saturated in Omnipotence.”**
> *- SB, p. 69*
>
> **“Unit + Energy fullness = Activeness.”**
> *- SB, p. 69*

SB and MVD state the reciprocal structure of manifestation:

> **“Thus, without basic impulsion, the energy remains unmanifest, and without the energy, there is no basic impulsion.”**
> *- SB, p. 62*
>
> **“Without absolute energy, there is no basic impulsion in matter, and without matter, absolute energy is not revealed. Nature is eternally present in absolute energy.”**
> *- MVD, p. 40*

Mutual dependence for manifestation names this reciprocal structure: the ground’s uniform energy and unit-activity appear together. Neither pole creates the other’s existence — only its manifestation. Regulation, activeness, and forcefulness in a unit are **read from** saturation (SB, p. 57), not pushed in from outside as an efficient cause.

Satta is actionless in itself, yet called energy because unit-activity manifests through **basic impulsion** — each unit’s inherent drive to be active given saturation, not an external push.

1.3 What every unit is

Every saturated unit carries the same four inseparable aspects — form, properties, essential nature, and *dharma* — regardless of order. They are not optional descriptors; they are what each unit **is** as a participant in coexistence (MVD, pp. 50–51).

Form (*roop*) is shared across all orders — shape, volume, and density by which a bounded unit is individuated (MVD, pp. 50, 112).

Properties (*gun*) name the effects units have on one another in mutuality, differentiated as **generative**, **degenerative**, and **mediative** — assisting creation, dissolution, and sustainment (MVD, pp. 50–51).

Essential nature (*svabhav* — Editorial Notes; not Buddhist *svabhava*) is how the usefulness of a unit’s properties participates in its order (MVD, pp. 50–51, 112).

Dharma names what a unit cannot be separated from — its innateness and fulfilment (SB, p. 50). Since existence is coexistence, indestructibility itself is the ultimate *dharma*.

SB opens with three companion facts:

> **“Each unit is a whole along with its environment.”**
> *- SB, p. 13*
>
> **“Each unit is orderliness with its ness and participates in overall orderliness.”**
> *- SB, p. 13*
>
> **“Each unit moves towards ‘development’ in its natural state and ‘decline’ in its excited state.”**
> *- SB, p. 14*

Unit + environment = the unit as a whole signifies continuity (SB, p. 51). ***Ness*** names unit-kind (*tv*): the spontaneity in expression of being itself, made evident through essential nature under naturalness (SB, p. 54).

Participation means **recognising and fulfilling** — observable even in the physicochemical realm, where components within an atom recognise and fulfil one another (SB, p. 123). Endeavour aligned with a unit's innateness moves toward fulfilment; endeavour against it gives rise to problems (MVD, p. 112).

JV illustrates definite conduct: a peepal tree maintains its conduct with all its fruits, seeds, and leaves exhibiting peepal's properties, intrinsic nature, and *dharma* (JV, p. 113). Harmony among the four aspects is what MVD calls the essence of coexistence itself (MVD, p. 21).

1.4 All change is unit-activity

All change in coexistence is **unit-activity** — the single inseparable triad of **effort, motion, and result** (*shram–gati–parinam*):

> **"Every physical-chemical activity is an inseparable presence of effort, motion and result. Each of these is a joint form of the other two."**
> *- SB, p. 58*

Effort, motion, and result are not three sequential steps but three inseparable aspects of one activity. Sodium and chlorine ions approaching one another: the approach is effort and motion together; the stable salt crystal is result — yet after reciprocal exchange both parties attain satisfaction or **natural motion** (*svabhav gati*), cyclical restoration to natural state rather than one-way extraction (SB, pp. 52–53).

Two structural patterns follow in the insentient orders:

- **State and motion are inseparable**: there is force in state, power in motion (SB, pp. 248–249).
- **Give–take complementarity**: after reciprocal exchange, both parties attain satisfaction or natural motion — not one-way extraction (SB, pp. 52–53).

Mediative activity — the hidden energy that normalises generative and degenerative charge in mutuality — continuously works toward equilibrium because its aim is completeness (SB, p. 70).

The texts distinguish **origination** (units co-eternally present) from **causation** (what produces change when units transform). Omnipresence grounds all units through saturation as **supreme cause** (*mahakaran*) in the sustaining sense — the ground of activity, not its trigger (MVD, pp. 288–289; SB, pp. 49, 62). The causal work of change is done by units themselves.

SB compresses saturation through development as an identity-chain — each link is identity ("itself is"), not an external push:

> **“Saturation in uniform energy itself is forcefulness, forcefulness itself is basic impulsion, basic impulsion itself is activity, activity itself is effort-motion-result, effort-motion-result itself is development and its continuity.”**
> *- SB, p. 62*

At the sentient level the same triad is read toward stages of completeness; that reading is developed in §1.9–1.10 once the four orders and *jeevan* are in view.

Time (*kaal*) is the **duration of unit-activity** — inseparable from effort, motion, and result in active units, not a separate cosmic container alongside *satta* and units. Full treatment: Nature of Time.

1.5 The four orders of nature

Madhyasth Darshan names four **orders** in nature — material (*padarth*), pranic/bio (*pran*), animal (*jeev*), and knowledge/human (*gyan*). Each is a stable plateau in development. Higher orders **include** the *dharma*s of lower orders cumulatively (SB, p. 179; MVD, p. 115).

Order	Essential nature (*svabhav*)	*Dharma* (cumulative)
Material (*padarth*)	integration–disintegration (*sangathan–vighatan*)	existence (*astitva*)
Bio (*pran*)	vitalising–devitalising (*sarak–marak*)	+ growth (*pushti*)
Animal (*jeev*)	cruel–uncruel	+ hope to live (*jeene ki aasha*)
Knowledge / human (*gyan*)	fortitude, courage, generosity, kindness, grace, compassion	+ happiness (*sukh*)

> **“Existence is not just physicochemical matter, but all physical, chemical and jeevan entities are inseparably present in Omnipresence.”**
> *- MVD, p. 5*

The human being is a **joint form** of physical body (*shareer*) and sentient self (*jeevan*):

> **“Brahma (Omnipotence) is omnipresent, and jeevan-clouds are many.”**
> *- MVD, p. 13*

These are **objective categories in nature**, not human typologies. Each order cyclically manifests through saturation in a different mode (MVD, p. 289):

Order	Cyclical manifestation through saturation
Material (*padarth*)	Units are **active** because of being in Omnipresence
Bio (*pran*)	Units have **pulsation** because of being in it
Animal (*jeev*)	Units have the **hope of living** because of being in it
Knowledge / Human (*gyan*)	Units are **hopeful and conscientious** because of being in it

SB notes that the biological order can revert to the material order after manifesting its essentiality, whereas irreversible atomic development crosses only at constitutional completeness (SB, pp. 76–78). *Countless* means practical uncountability — real particulars, indefinitely many from any finite standpoint (SB, p. 49).

1.6 Units in relationships

Saturation names the relation between Omnipresence and every unit. Existence also contains **ontological relations between units**. Nothing in nature is isolated — "nothing is isolated – that is the principle" (JV, p. 43).

MVD defines a **relationship** as "the mutuality where expectations are predetermined in the sense of completeness" (MVD, p. 62), and contrasts it with **association** — "the mutuality where expectations are voluntary" (MVD, p. 61).

Essentiality in every order is **value** — what units reciprocate and mutually recognise in mutuality:

> **"Entire beingness implies the essentiality of units in every plane and order. Essentiality refers to value… It is values that are reciprocated and mutually recognised, as complementarity, mutual recognition, and impression occur only in mutuality."**
> *- SB, p. 50*

Impression names the describable event in which one unit's activity registers on another in mutuality — alongside complementarity and mutual recognition.

Every unit **recognises** its relationships and **fulfils** them through **capacity** (*kshamata*), **ability** (*yogyata*), and **receptivity** (*patrata*) at the level of its order (MVD, p. 62):

> **"Every entity of nature recognises another; that is why it fulfils. An atomic particle too recognises another, and as a result, these particles abide in orderliness."**
> *- JV, p. 69*

The **completeness drive** (SB, p. 51) orients unit-activity toward fulfilling relationships at ever higher stages. Units move toward terminal satisfaction by recognising and fulfilling relationships provisioned in coexistence — not by maximising an abstract quantity. When those relationships are fully evident across nature, the texts call that **realisation in coexistence** (SB, p. 51): not a new state of the ground, but fulfilment made clear within coexistence.

In the first three orders, units fulfil **definitely** — structural, seed, or species conformance (JV, pp. 48, 113). In the knowledge order, recognition and fulfilment pass through knowing, believing, evaluation, and choice (JV, p. 48; MVD, p. 77) and must be **achieved**.

1.6.1 Fulfilment through the orders

At every order, fulfilment evidences **use, right-use, and purposeful-use** (MVD, p. 27). What counts as fulfilment differs by order because each order's *dharma* and mode of lawful conformance differ.

Order	What fulfilment evidences	Plain outcome
Material (*padarth*)	Use, right-use, purposeful-use; complementary exchange → satisfaction (MVD p. 27; SB pp. 52–53)	Stable composition; orderliness in atoms and molecules; no one-way depletion
Bio (*pran*)	Same use triad; seed-conformance; *dharma* includes growth (*pushti*)	Vital balance; persistence in natural state
Animal (*jeev*)	Same use triad; species-conformance; hope to live	Definite species conduct; cruel–uncruel balance
Knowledge / human (*gyan*)	Use triad **plus** evaluative closure when values are assessed and relationships close (MVD p. 62)	Conduct and thought aligned with coexistence — developed in §1.10.1 and §1.13

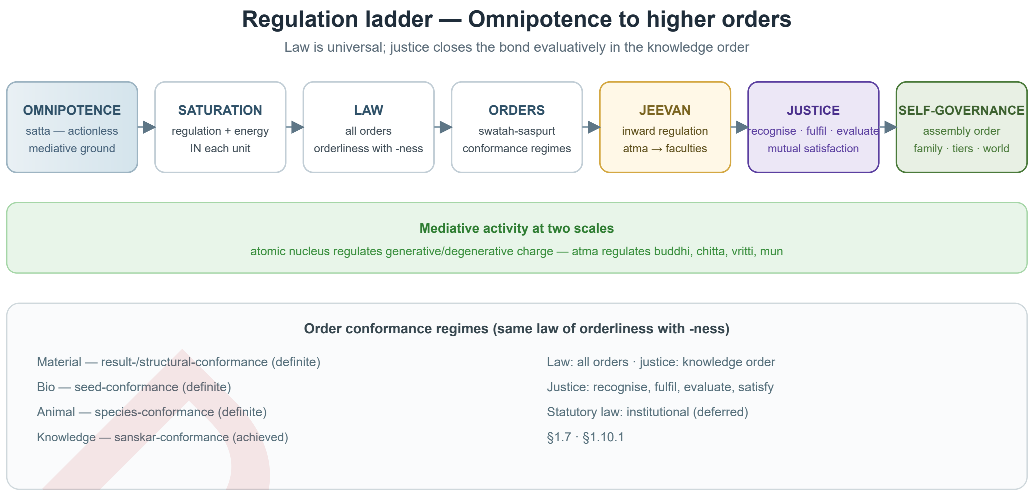
Capacity (*kshamata*) sets the scope for participating in a relationship; **ability** (*yogyata*) converts that scope into effort; **receptivity** (*patrata*) determines whether values register and fulfilment (*nirvaha*) can complete. In lower orders the three operate definitely; in humans, awakening or decline depends on how they are used (MVD, pp. 79, 134). Atomic bonding — hungry and overfull atoms complementary (MVD, p. 8) — is relationship-recognition at the material tier.

1.7 Regulation and law

Saturation provisions inherent energy and regulatory order **in** each unit. The **regulation ladder** reads that bond upward: saturation → law → order-specific conformance → inward regulation in *jeevan* → evaluative closure in the knowledge order → assembly self-governance. *Satta* does not descend as statutory command.

> **“Regulation itself becomes clear in the form of law. Consequently, there is provision in every unit for recognising one another based on law. This itself is the meaning of regulation.”**
> *- SB, p. 57*
>
> **“Omnipotence is mediative, therefore the nature saturated in it is regulated and conserved. The nucleus within every atom is the mediative activity, whereby the atom’s generative-degenerative activities and relative powers are regulated and conserved.”**
> *- MVD, p. 26*

Orderliness (*vyavastha*) at the level of co-existing orders is **self-regulation** (*swatah-saspurt*) — inherent in nature’s orders, not dispensed by a cosmic governor.



Law names how regulation and orderliness are **already structurally real** in coexistence — the **law of orderliness with *ness***, expressed in order-specific **conformance regimes**:

Order	Conformance mode	Definite or achieved
Material (*padarth*)	Result- / structural-conformance	Definite
Bio (*pran*)	Seed-conformance	Definite
Animal (*jeev*)	Species-conformance	Definite
Knowledge / human (*gyan*)	*Sanskar*-conformance	Achieved through knowing → believing → recognising → fulfilling

Below the knowledge order, lawful recognition and fulfilment need no separate name for evaluation. Once *jeevan* must evaluate and can err, the texts name the evaluative closure of the relational cycle **justice** (*nyaya*). The six **perspectives** (*drishti*) through which humans evaluate are treated under *jeevan* in §1.10.1. **Statutory and public law** (*dharma-niti*, *rajya-niti*) codifies assembly order separately; conduct may satisfy legality while violating justice. Institutional governance belongs in the planned *Governance Justice and Undivided Society* study.

1.8 Composition and assemblies

When complementary units fulfil their relationships, they **compose** into larger units:

> **"Everywhere, there exists a natural inclination towards coexistence. This inclination is what leads atomic particles to assemble into atoms, atoms to combine into molecules, and molecules to combine into molecular forms."**
> *- JV, p. 67*

In a **mixture** (*mishran*), components maintain their respective conducts. In a **compound** (*yaugik*), components combine in definite proportion and present a genuinely new unit with its own four-aspect signature (MVD, p. 42).

Composition is not development. The developmental plateau is crossed only when an **atom** reaches constitutional completeness. Assemblies **persist** while relationships are fulfilled in their natural state and **decline** when they are not (SB, p. 14). Transmission of composition method (*rachna vidhi*) runs by constitution, seed, lineage, or education-*sanskar* according to order (JV, pp. 48, 82; MVD, pp. 92–93). Formal articulation: The Coexistence Template.

When assemblies are **human** compositions — family, community, and society — the same persist-or-decline rule applies, but recognition and fulfilment are **achieved** and evaluative rather than definite. Human assemblies, like molecules and bodies, are real compositions whose durability tracks relationship-fulfilment, not fear or extraction alone. Assembly-scale outcomes at awakened sociality are developed in §1.13.

1.9 Development, planes, and the sentience threshold

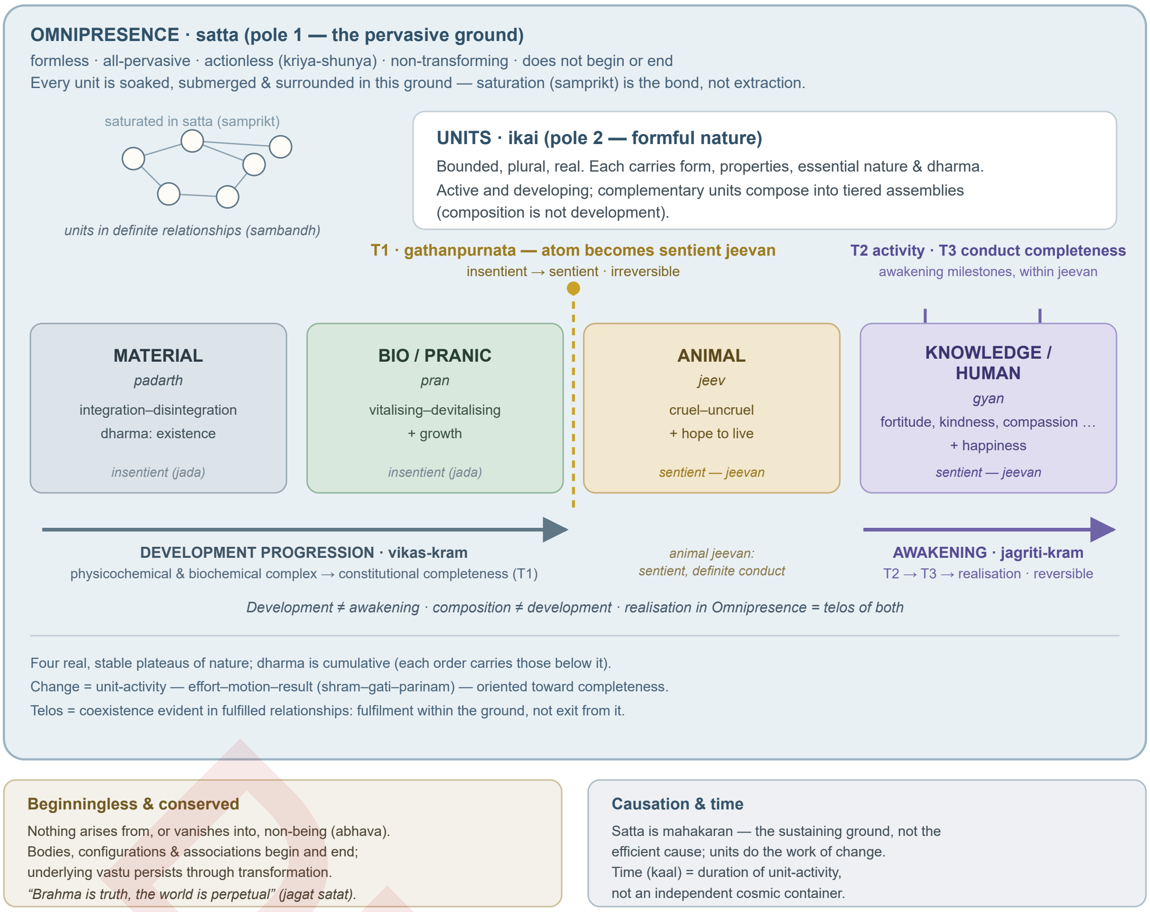
Nature saturated in state-complete Omnipotence is oriented for **development and awakening until realisation in coexistence** (SB, p. 51). Two progressions carry that orientation and must not be collapsed:

- **Development progression** (*vikas-kram*): through the physicochemical complex until an atom reaches **constitutional completeness** and sentient *jeevan* appears.
- **Awakening progression** (*jagriti-kram*): within constitutionally complete *jeevan*, toward fuller **activity** and **conduct**.

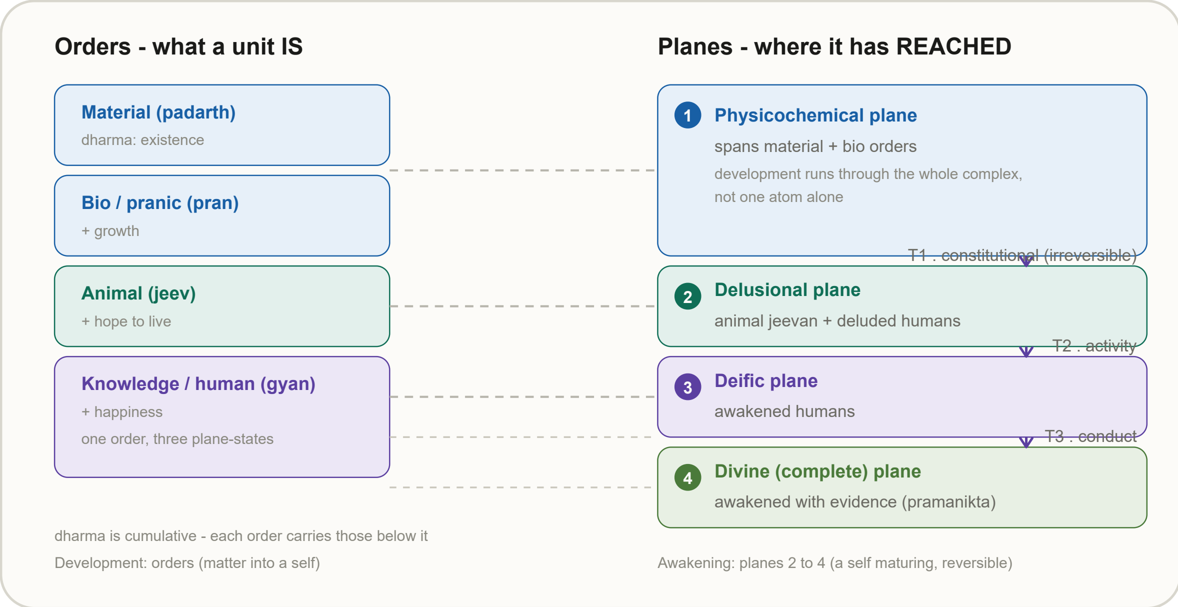
In the sentient register, effort–motion–result maps to those stages: result toward constitutional completeness; effort toward activity completeness; motion toward conduct completeness (SB, p. 58). Sentient nature also works through projection and reflection toward relational closure (*samadhan*) at the knowledge order (SB, pp. 60, 64–65, 69).

Madhyasth Darshan — the architecture of coexistence

Beginningless coexistence: two co-eternal poles, neither made from the other — the world fully real.



Orders name what a unit **is**; **planes** (*pad*) name where development has reached (SB, p. 52). SB lists the physicochemical, delusional, deific, and divine (complete) planes.



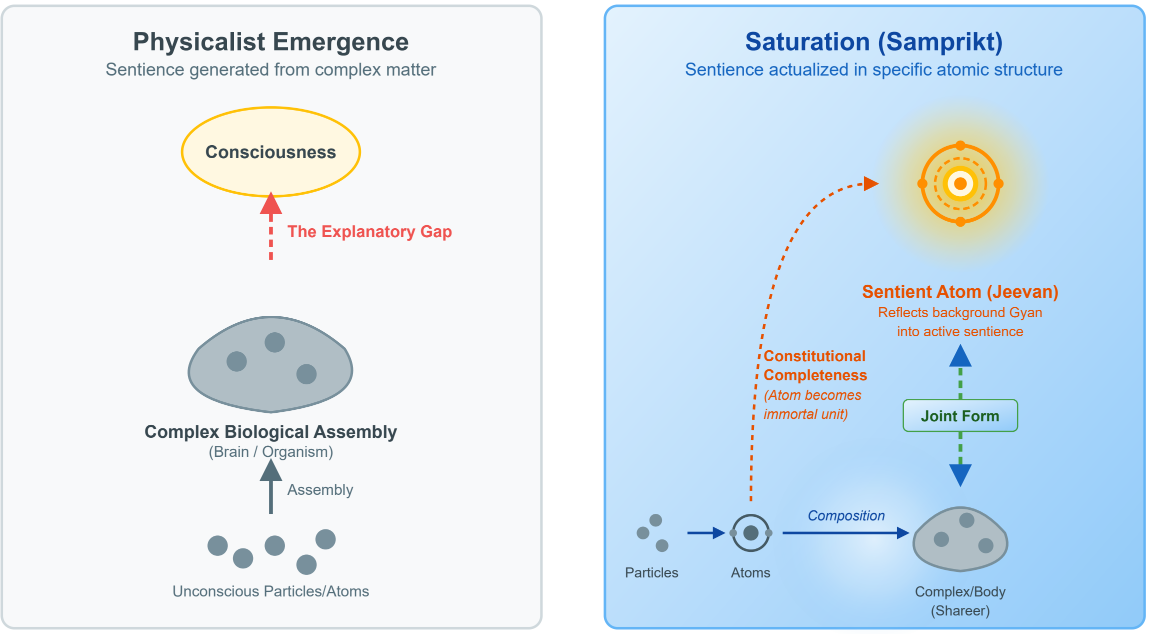
Transition	Completeness stage	From → to	What becomes evident
T1	Constitutional completeness (*gathanpurnata*)	Physicochemical → delusional	Sentient *jeevan*; hope to live

T1 is **irreversible** at the atomic level (SB, p. 92). Molecules exhibit characteristics of development but not **actual** development; the sentient threshold is constitutional completeness of the atom (SB, p. 52).

An insentient atom (*parmanu*) — a **composite** of nucleus and orbiting particles (MVD, p. 42) — reaches *gathanpurnata* through particle incorporation, hungry and overfull complementarity, and environmental mutuality (MVD, p. 8; SB, pp. 58, 71). When the required particles are integrated, the atom becomes constitutionally complete: satisfaction within, by, and for that constitution — immortality of result and sentient status (SB, p. 59).

In this state there is neither increase nor decrease in particle count; the atom undergoes **qualitative change without quantitative change** (SB, p. 55).

Tiered intelligibility: all saturated units participate in inherent orderliness. Insentient units exhibit radiance and projection (SB, p. 69). At *gathanpurnata*, a stable atom-configuration acts as a **mediating configuration** through which orderliness manifests as active sentience — sentience is not generated from dead matter but actualized at constitutional completeness. The four registers of knowledge in coexistence are distinguished in §1.11.



1.10 *Jeevan*: structure and awakening

Jeevan — the sentient self that works through the body (*shareer*) — is the constitutionally complete unit whose threshold was traced at T1. Animal-order *jeevan* and deluded knowledge-order humans occupy the delusional plane; awakening moves a human through the deific plane toward the divine plane.

MVD lists five inseparable aspects — *mun*, *vritti*, *chitta*, *buddhi*, and *atma* — within the *jeevan*-cloud (MVD, p. 13). They operate through the projection and reflection cycle (*paravartan* and *pratyavartan*):

Strength / power	**Projection (*paravartan*)**	**Reflection (*pratyavartan*)**
Mun / hope	selection	taste (*asvad*)
Vritti / thought	analysis	deliberation
Chitta / desire	visualisation	contemplation
Buddhi	resolve (*sankalp*)	enlightenment (*bodh*)
Atma	authenticity (*pramanikta*)	realisation (*anubhav*)

> **"The mode of channelling jeevan's energies towards development (awakening) is through curiosity in mun, enthusiasm in vritti, delight in chitta, elation and immersion in buddhi, and finally, realisation in atma. For this, inward regulation of jeevan energies is essential."**
> \- *MVD, p. 77*

Inward regulation is ontological self-regulation within the sentient unit — *atma* as mediative activity disciplines the lower faculties and body (MVD, p. 277), parallel to mediative regulation at the atomic nucleus (§1.7).

Mistaking the body for the self is the root of delusion (SB, pp. 91–92). *Jeevan* does not sleep when the body sleeps; values and evaluation are *jeevan*'s practical purpose. At the knowledge order, **perceiver status** (*drishta pad*) — enlightenment and realisation within the truth of coexistence — is what awakened humans attain; activity completeness (T2) and conduct completeness (T3) evidence it in orderliness with *ness* and living proof (SB, pp. 137–138, 159).

> **"Jeevan continues to exist even after death as it does while driving a body."**
> - *JV, p. 20*

Post-death continuity is philosophical inference within the darshan (§6.2.4, §6.4).

Transition	Completeness stage	From → to	What becomes evident
T2	Activity (*kriyapurnata*)	Delusional → deific	Awakened humans; orderliness with *ness*
T3	Conduct (*vyavaharpurnata*)	Deific → divine (complete)	Awakened humans with evidence (*pramanikta*)

In the knowledge order, *jeevan*'s design includes six provisioned evaluative **perspectives** (*drishti*), treated next in §1.10.1.

1.10.1 Evaluative perspectives: justice, dharma, and truth

Evaluation belongs to *jeevan* in the knowledge order alone (JV, p. 70). It does not proceed through a single lens. *Jeevan*'s design provisions six **perspectives** through which knowing, believing, evaluation, and choice assess activity in coexistence — and in awakening, **humane refuge** reorganizes under *nyaya*, *dharma*, and *satya* rather than *priya*, *hita*, and *labh* (MVD, pp. 27, 67).

> **“All human behaviour is manifest in six perspectives: - (1) pleasant-unpleasant, (2) healthy-unhealthy, (3) profit-loss, (4) justice-injustice, (5) dharma-adharma, and (6) truth-untruth.”**
> *- MVD, p. 67*
>
> **“The behaviour of humans with inhumane perspective is in the refuge of pleasant-unpleasant, healthy-unhealthy, and profit-loss. The behaviour of humans with humane perspective is in the refuge of justice-injustice, dharma-adharma, and truth-untruth.”**
> *- MVD, p. 67*

Each perspective becomes clear with respect to a definite domain (MVD, p. 66):

Perspective	Becomes clear with respect to	Role in evaluation
Priya–apriya	Instincts / sense-objects	Lower refuge; insufficient as organizing standpoint
Hita–ahita	Body	Same
Labh–alabh	Material goods and comforts	Same
Nyaya–anyaya	**Behaviour** (*vyavahar*)	Humane refuge; regulates conduct
Dharma–adharma	**Resolution** (*samadhan*)	Humane refuge; disciplines thought
Satya–asatya	**Realisation in existence**	Humane refuge; grounds assessment in what is ultimately real

The lower triad is provisioned and legitimate at its domain — food and instinct, bodily health, livelihood and material comfort — but denied **sufficiency** as the organizing refuge of a knowledge-order being. Awakening **subordinates** rather than abandons those domains: pleasant, healthy, and profitable outcomes remain meaningful when ordered under justice, dharma, and truth (Ethics and Morals in Human Beings §3.2).

Unit **dharma** (§1.3) — the fourth aspect of every unit’s signature — must not be confused with the **dharma–adharma perspective**: the latter is an evaluative *drishti* on thought and resolution, not the innateness and fulfilment of a unit as such.

The three humane perspectives regulate distinct registers of evaluative life (MVD, p. 137):

> **“The regulation of human behaviour takes place through justice, discipline in thoughts takes place through dharma, and realisation takes place only through truth.”**
> *- MVD, p. 137*

Register	Humane perspective	What evaluation disciplines
Conduct	*Nyaya–anyaya*	Behaviour in relationships — just or unjust
Thought	*Dharma–adharma*	Deliberation and intention toward resolution
Realisation	*Satya–asatya*	Whether assessment is grounded in coexistence as it is

Justice (*nyaya*) carries a **dual role**. As a **perspective**, it assesses behaviour just or unjust — conduct relative to relationship and humaneness. As an **ontological name**, it designates the **complete relational activity** when that assessment closes the cycle: relationships recognised, values fulfilled, **evaluated**, and brought to **mutual satisfaction**. Justice is not trust, respect, or a moral value among values. Trust, respect, affection, and the other established values flow **in** relationships; justice is what happens when that flow is complete and assessed as such.

> **“Recognising relationships, fulfilling values, evaluating, and achieving mutual satisfaction is justice.”**
> *- MVD, p. 311*

JV states the same structure as justice “manifested through relationships, values, evaluation, and mutual satisfaction” (JV, p. 55). MVD also equates justice with humane behaviour itself: “Humane behaviour in mutuality itself is justice” (MVD, p. 35). The four-step cycle runs: recognise relationship → fulfil values → evaluate → mutual satisfaction. When that cycle completes in mutuality, the knowledge-order fulfilment outcomes named in §1.13 — **resolution**, **prosperity**, **fearlessness**, and **coexistence** — are evidenced in conduct.

Dharma as evaluative perspective disciplines **thought**. Deliberation through *vritti* can engage all six perspectives (MVD, p. 71); what changes in awakening is which refuge organizes the analysis. Deliberation from the humane triad is **balanced *vritti***; deliberation stuck in the lower triad is **unbalanced *vritti***. Visualisation through *chitta* from the humane triad is **yathartha** (real); from the lower triad it is **unreal** — imposition of liking, bodily interest, or gain onto what is (MVD, pp. 126–127). The dharma–adharma perspective evaluates whether thought tends toward **resolution** (*samadhan*) or toward disorder.

Satya as evaluative perspective grounds assessment in **realisation in existence** — whether deliberation and conduct align with coexistence as ultimately real, not merely with what is pleasant (*preyas*), bodily expedient, or profitable. Realisation through *atma* is the terminal reflection in the faculty cycle (§1.10); the satya–asatya perspective asks whether evaluation itself takes refuge in that register or remains trapped in lower comparison.

Below the knowledge order, recognition and fulfilment are lawful and definite without bearing the name *justice*, because evaluation and the possibility of error are not yet in play. In the knowledge order, justice, dharma, and truth together structure how *jeevan* evaluates — behaviour, thought, and realisation — not as three optional ideals but as the humane refuge provisioned in *jeevan*'s design.

Register	Scope	Ontological status
Regulation / law	All four orders	Inherent in saturated units; same law of orderliness with *ness*
Justice (*nyaya*)	Knowledge order	Complete relational activity: recognise, fulfil, evaluate, mutual satisfaction
Statutory / public law	Assemblies, society	Institutional codification; may diverge from justice

Formal structure: The Coexistence Template and Category Theory Explained.

1.11 Knowledge in coexistence

Four registers must be kept apart when reading the texts on knowledge:

1. **Realisation Knowledge** (*anubhav jnan*, MVD p. 11) — the ontological **given**: saturated units with form, properties, essential nature, *dharma*, and orderliness (already stated in §1.1).
2. ***Gyan*** **as *satta*** (MVD p. 35) — the state-complete intelligibility-ground that conserves and regulates all activity without performing it.
3. ***Realisation in coexistence*** (MVD p. 116; SB p. 51) — the telos named in §1.6: relationships fulfilled and evident, not a new state of the ground.
4. ***Gyan udghatan*** — the unfolding of knowledge; occurs **only** through awakened *jeevan*, not through insentient units or Omnipresence acting as a knower (MVD pp. 115–116, 289).

Gyan as *satta* names relational, evaluatively structured orderliness — not merely statistical regularity. Orderliness in all saturated units and active sentience at *gathanpurnata* are distinct registers. Epistemic evidence: Knowledge, Knower, and Known.

1.12 Conservation and the perpetual world

Madhyasth Darshan advances **two conservation claims** that must be kept apart.

Coexistence conservation holds that what exists does not arise from non-being (*abhava*) and does not vanish into it — only configurations, bodies, and associations begin and end

(§4.4). Conservation is asserted of **each** existing particular through configuration change.

***Jeevan* persistence** is a separate commitment — inferred from constitutional immortality together with conservation (JV, p. 20; MVD Reality proposition 9; §6.2.4, §6.4).

Existence is **beginningless**:

> **"That which exists continues to be, and that which was not, does not come into existence. Therefore, existence will remain as it is till eternity."**
> *- SB, p. 49*
>
> **"Nothing arrives at birth nor does anything depart with death. All that is, exists forever."**
> *- JV, p. 20*

Underlying *vastu* persists through transformation (*roopantaran*), never annihilated into absolute non-being.

MVD compresses the positive ontology:

> **"Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual."**
> *- MVD, p. 13*

Madhyasth Darshan's *jagat satat* (perpetual world) stands in structural contrast with Advaita's *jagat mithya* (§5.7). Coexistence as an **organic whole** does not dissolve plurality into the ground: Brahman (*satta*) remains state-complete while countless units remain state-dynamic, each progressing as unit-and-environment toward completeness. **Realisation in Omnipresence** is coexistence evident in fulfilment — a perpetual structured world, not a world sublated at the highest truth.

1.13 Ontology and societal fulfilment outcomes

Relationship-recognition and value-fulfilment are built into what units are. At the knowledge order these mechanisms become explicit through the six *drishti*, the justice cycle, and effort–motion–result oriented toward resolution (*samadhan*). Ethics is not an optional layer on an indifferent material base. A constitutionally complete *jeevan* is asked to recognise the sentient self as distinct from the body, to elevate lower *drishti* toward humane *nyaya*, *dharma*, and *satya*, and to fulfil relationships toward activity and conduct completeness.

What coexistence **provisions** must be distinguished from what humans **achieve**. Relationships carry expectations toward completeness; regulation and law are inherent in saturated units; the six perspectives and the justice cycle structure evaluation. None of this guarantees prosperity, trust, or order regardless of conduct. Delusion, legality without justice, **accumulation** detached from right-use expenditure, **false learning** stuck in doubt and mis-evaluation, and **fear** as lack of wisdom remain live failures at the knowledge order

— the deluded-side counterparts to prosperity, coexistence-understanding, and fearlessness (MVD, pp. 263–264). What the ontology **commits** to is the **structure of what successful human living evidences** when the relational cycle closes — not automatic outcomes under coercion or survival-optimisation alone.

JV names the human goal in four terms:

> **"The goal of jeevan is happiness, and the human goal is resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, and coexistence. Ethics are essential for achieving these goals and give them purpose."**
> *- JV, p. 165*

The quote names two goal-levels: *jeevan*'s own goal is happiness (*sukh*), while **human** living at the knowledge order evidences resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, and coexistence together. JV ties all of these to **ethics** — right-use of body, mind, and wealth — to **character** — rightfully owned wealth, marital faithfulness, kindness in conduct — and to **values** — evaluation and mutual satisfaction in relationships. Those three strands are the conduct structure the justice cycle presupposes, not optional decoration on an indifferent base.

MVD states what awakened sociality rests on — study, production, and orderliness, not fear-bound herd behaviour:

> **"The semblance of collectivity among animals is generally observed only in situations of fear. Under no circumstances is such collectivity observed in activities of study, production, or the maintenance of orderliness. In contrast, the foundational basis of sociality in awakened humans is living in resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, and coexistence."**
> *- MVD, Ch. 4*

MVD adds a sharper contrast in the same chapter: animals are widely known for eating, sleeping, fear, and mating alone, whereas awakened humans commonly live with the **desire-trio** — progeny-motive, wealth-motive, reputation-motive — **and** evidence the four outcomes with **restfulness** (*vishram*). In that register, **resolution itself is restfulness**, which the texts also name *abhyudaya* — comprehensive resolution, not merely private calm.

Outcome	Plain meaning	Tied to
Resolution (*samadhan*)	Understanding and relational closure without residue; intellectual resolution and material prosperity as joint evidence of complete happiness (MVD, p. 106)	*Dharma–adharma* perspective on thought

Outcome	Plain meaning	Tied to
Prosperity	Material adequacy through production beyond need and right-use — not hoarding or profit-maximisation (MVD, pp. 106, 263)	Justice cycle in conduct; use triad at knowledge order
Fearlessness	Trust in the present; sociality not founded on fear	Contrast with animal collectivity under threat (MVD, Ch. 4); mutual satisfaction in relationships
Coexistence	Living with complementarity — among humans and with nature	*Satya–asatya* perspective; right-use toward undivided humankind

Resolution is what *dharma* disciplines in thought; **prosperity** is what justice evidences in behaviour when relationships close evaluatively; **satya** grounds both in realisation in existence rather than in liking, bodily expedience, or gain alone. **Fearlessness** names the social register the texts prefer to fear-based **security**: optimising protection or survival alone can build the kind of collectivity MVD attributes to animals under threat, whereas awakened humans base sociality on resolved understanding, adequate production, trust, and complementarity.

Resolved human conduct (*manaviya aacharan*) is coexistence made evident in daily living. When the justice cycle completes — recognise relationship, fulfil values, evaluate, mutual satisfaction — trust, affection, care, and the other established values flow **in** relationships; justice is the name for that closure as a whole, and the four outcomes above are what it **evidences** at the knowledge order. Individual conduct composes upward: family and community persist while relationships are fulfilled in their natural state and decline when they are not. MVD names the assembly-scale telos **undivided society** (*akhand samaj*), evidenced together with **universal orderliness** when sectarian or fear-bound groupings mature into humankind as one complementary whole (MVD, Ch. 4). Activity completeness (T2) evidences orderliness with *ness*; conduct completeness (T3) evidences living proof (*pramanikta*) — coexistence not merely believed but displayed.

Understanding without adequate living remains incomplete, and material plenty without resolution remains unfulfilled. Character, conduct, family formation, and institutional self-governance belong in linked ethics and society studies; the ontology here states what successful human living **evidences** when the relational cycle closes.

2. The Advaita Vedanta Answer

Advaita Vedanta holds that existence in the strictest, absolute sense is **Brahman** alone — one without a second (*ekamevaditiyam*). The world of names, forms, bodies, and relations is

mithya — a dependent appearance operationally valid at the empirical level (*vyavahara*) but ultimately sublated at absolute reality (*paramartha*). The true Self (*Atman*) is neither born nor destroyed, because it is ultimately identical with this non-dual Brahman.

The account proceeds in layers. It begins with **Brahman** as absolute existence and **Sat-Chit-Ananda**, then separates the **three tiers of reality** (*pratibhasika*, *vyavahara*, *paramartha*). **Maya**, **adhyasa**, and causal doctrine (*satkaryavada*, *vivartavada*) explain how multiplicity appears on changeless Brahman. The **empirical entities** — Ishvara, jiva, and jagat — structure the shared world. **Witness-consciousness** (*sakshin*, *turiya*) names the irreducible seer discriminated from body and mind. **Conservation**, origination, and temporality divide timeless Brahman from law-governed *vyavahara*. **Liberation** (*moksha*) and the knowledge path state how the illusion of separateness is dispelled. The section closes with **ethics**, *loka-sangraha*, and what realization **evidences** at the empirical order. The full architecture is summarised in the figure at §2.5. Advaita terms are defined in Quick Glossary, **Terms in §2**.

2.1 Brahman and absolute existence

> **"In the beginning this was Existence alone, One only, without a second."**
> *- CU 6.2.1*

Shankara glosses *sat* as:

> **"mere Existence, a thing that is subtle, without distinction, all pervasive, one, taintless, partless, consciousness"**
> *- CU 6.2.1, Shankara commentary*

Advaita's opening move parallels Madhyasth Darshan's refusal of origination from non-being, but compresses the answer differently. The text rejects existence arising from non-existence:

> **"By what logic can existence verily come out of non-existence? But surely, o good looking one, in the beginning all this was Existence, One only, without a second."**
> *- CU 6.2.2*

At ***paramartha***, only this one partless reality exists absolutely. *Paramatman* is not a second absolute beside Brahman — it is Brahman named from the empirical or devotional register, sublated together with Ishvara and jiva when superimposition is perfectly eliminated (VC, v. 244; §2.5).

2.2 Sat-Chit-Ananda and the three states

A second classical formulation names existence not only as *sat* — bare being — but as **Sat-Chit-Ananda**: being-consciousness-bliss. These are not three realities added together; Brahman is one partless reality whose nature is expressed in three inseparable names.

> **"Brahman is Truth, Knowledge, and Infinity."**
> *- TU 2.1.1*

Shankara's tradition reads *satyam* as being/reality, *jnanam* as consciousness, and *anantam* as the infinite. The *anandamaya* passage (TU 2.5) leads the seeker beyond even bliss-as-sheath to the Self beyond all coverings. Shankara states the mature formula in the *Vivekachudamani*:

> **"By that alone he comes to know his own Self as Existence-Knowledge-Bliss Absolute and becomes happy."**
> *- VC, v. 152*

The same triad recurs at v. 217, one of the most comprehensive Self-descriptions in the *Vivekachudamani*:

> **"That which clearly manifests Itself in the states of wakefulness, dream and profound sleep; which is inwardly perceived in the mind in various forms as an unbroken series of egoistic impressions; which witnesses the egoism, the Buddhi, etc., which are of diverse forms and modifications; and which makes Itself felt as the Existence-Knowledge-Bliss Absolute; know thou this Atman, thy own Self, within thy heart."**
> *- VC, v. 217*

In this scheme, ***sat*** names absolute being; ***chit*** names consciousness as the very nature of reality and Self, not a function of brain or mind; ***ananda*** names the intrinsic fullness of the Self, free from lack and dependence on objects. Advaita concentrates existence in one subject whose nature is being, consciousness, and bliss without a second.

The Mandukya Upanishad (MU, vv. 3–7) grounds this analysis in the three states (*avastha-traya*): waking, dream, and deep sleep — with **turiya**, the witness beyond all states, as ultimately real. This first-person ladder is not a map of Madhyasth Darshan's four developmental **orders** (§1.5); it analyses how temporal **states** appear and are witnessed from within. Witness analysis is developed in §2.6; the Sat-Chit-Ananda contrast with distributed coexistence is developed in §5.5.

2.3 Three tiers of reality

Advaita's standard framework separates private apparent errors (*pratibhasika*, such as a rope mistaken for a snake) from shared empirical reality (*vyavahara*, which governs bodies, physical laws, ethics, and scripture) and the absolute truth of Brahman (*paramartha*). The *mithya* doctrine and the three-tier framework are related but distinct tools (Editorial Notes); both are needed to read Advaita's ontology.

> **"A firm conviction of the mind to the effect that Brahman is real and the universe unreal, is designated as discrimination (Viveka) between the Real and the unreal."**
> *- VC, v. 20*
>
> **"The individual soul is itself and directly the Supreme Brahman, and nothing else."**
> *- VC, v. 216*

Level	What exists?	Status of world / error
Apparent (*pratibhasika*)	Rope-snake, dream objects, private errors	Sublated by waking or correction
Empirical (*vyavahara*)	Bodies, minds, Ishvara, causes, duties, scriptures, science	Shared, law-governed; operationally valid; sublated only by *brahma-jnana*
Absolute (*paramartha*)	Brahman alone	World is *mithya*, dependent appearance

At *vyavahara*, the world is not unreal in the way a hallucination is; it is unreal **relative to Brahman** — like a dream relative to waking. The world is not sheer nothing, nor absolutely real; it is ***mithya*** — dependent appearance. Later Advaita systematises this as *anirvacaniya* ("indescribable" as either absolutely real or sheer nothing); Shankara uses "neither sat nor asat" language without that compound (Editorial Notes). That status matters when comparing Advaita's ethics and science with Madhyasth Darshan's perpetual world (§2.9, §6.3).

2.4 Maya, adhyasa, and causal doctrine

The multiplicity of the world rests on Brahman through **superimposition** (*adhyasa*) — like a snake seen on a rope. Cosmic **Maya** conceals Brahman's true nature (*avarana*) and projects the diversity of name-form (*vikshepa*). VC vv. 243–244 distinguish **Maya** (cosmic, Ishvara's superimposition) from **Avidya** (individual, the jiva's superimposition of body-mind on the Self). These are the structural concepts Madhyasth Darshan does not map to saturation (§5.7).

Advaita inherits **satkaryavada** from its Samkhya background: the effect pre-exists in the cause. The Chandogya clay teaching states the pattern:

> **“My dear, as by the knowledge of one lump of clay alone all things made of clay are known — for all transformation has speech as its basis, it being name, while clay alone is real — so, my dear, is this knowledge.”**
> *- CU 6.1.4*

The *Vivekachudamani* compresses the same point:

> **“All modifications of clay, such as the jar, which are always accepted by the mind as real, are (in reality) nothing but clay. Similarly, this entire universe which is produced from the real Brahman, is Brahman Itself and nothing but That.”**
> *- VC, v. 251*

At the empirical level, creation is **vivartavada** — apparent transformation of name-form on changeless Brahman. Brahman does not change; multiplicity is projected through Maya. The effect is not a real transformation of the cause. Creation is therefore not production from nothing; it is manifestation of names and forms on the basis of Brahman. Comparative causal doctrine across traditions is tabulated in §5.2.

The stock error of mistaking a rope for a snake illustrates Advaita’s theory of error (*khyati-vada*): the snake is neither real (it vanishes on knowledge) nor utterly unreal (it was genuinely experienced), but a projection on a real substrate — the same structure Maya writ large applies to the world until Brahman is known. Madhyasth Darshan treats error as removable misidentification within a fully real world, not an indescribable appearance over a sole reality (§5.7).

2.5 Ishvara, jiva, and jagat at *vyavahara*

Because Advaita uses a three-tier framework, it posits several categories structurally necessary to explain the empirical world, even if they are ultimately sublated at the absolute level. These are the specific concepts compared against Madhyasth Darshan in §5.

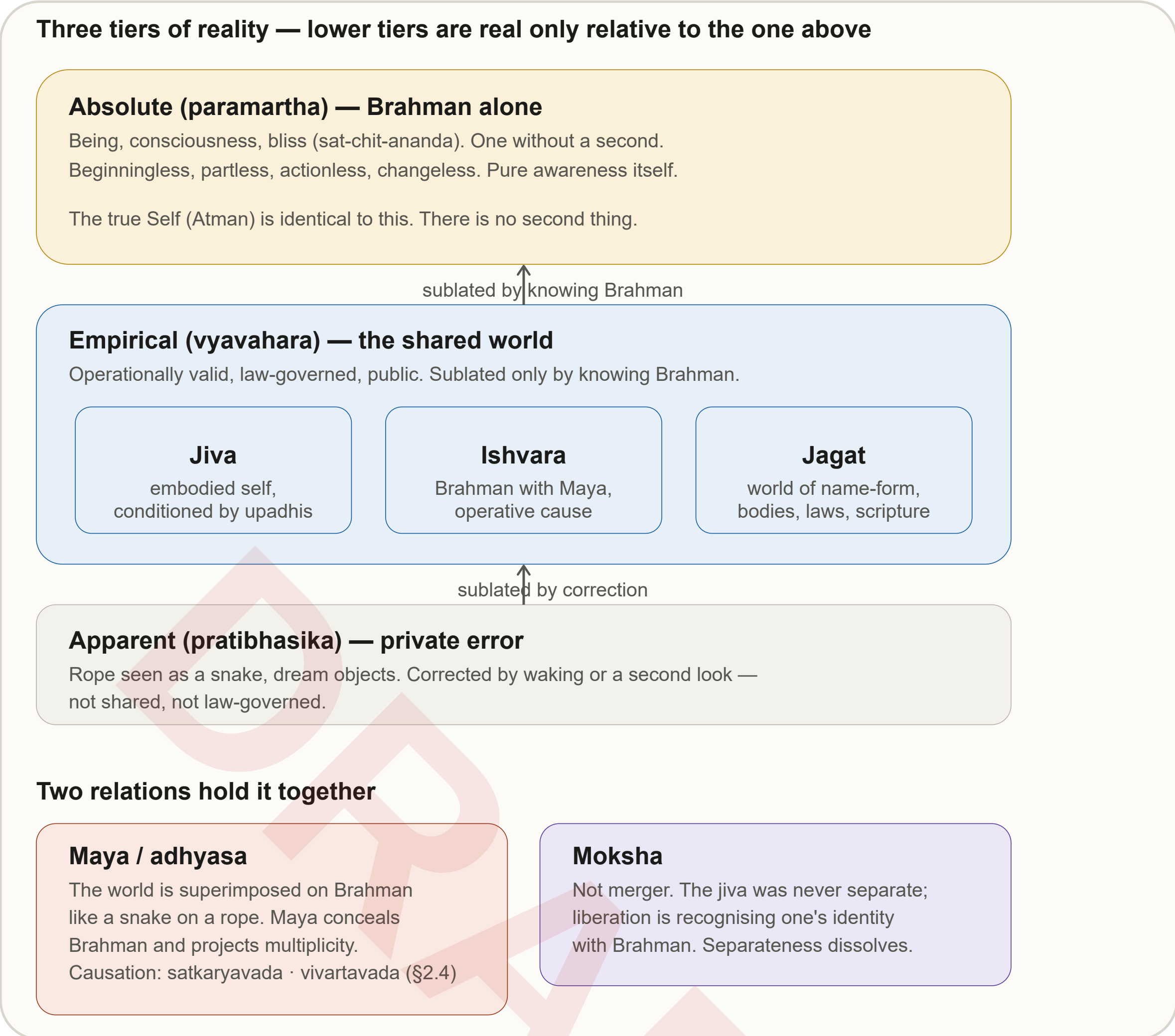
Brahman is the sole absolute reality (*paramartha*) — pure, actionless awareness. **Ishvara** (Saguna Brahman) is Brahman associated with *Maya*, functioning as operative cause of name-form manifestation — not a creator *ex nihilo*. Ishvara is a *vyavahara*-level category sublated at *paramartha* (VC, v. 244):

> **“These two are the superimpositions of Ishwara and the Jiva respectively, and when these are perfectly eliminated, there is neither Ishwara nor Jiva.”**
> *- VC, v. 244*

Jivatman (*jiva*) is the individual embodied soul — the true Self (*Atman*) conditioned by *upadhis* (limiting adjuncts such as body and mind), appearing as separate until realization.

Advaita's *Pancha Kosha* (five sheaths) language shares Upanishadic vocabulary with Madhyasth Darshan's order-and-plane exposition, but the two five-fold structures do not match one-to-one (§5.6, item 5); here the point is only that empirical individuality is **conditioned**, not that layers are discarded as unreal equipment.

Jagat (*nama-roopa*) is the physical universe of names and forms — operationally valid at *vyavahara*, ultimately *mithya* at *paramartha*. Bodies, minds, causal order, scripture, and science belong to this shared tier until *brahma-jnana* sublates the apparent separateness of the world from Brahman.



2.6 Witness-consciousness and the Self

The *Drig-Drishya-Viveka* (DDV) offers a rigorous seer-seen (*drig-drishya*) discrimination: whatever can be observed — body, sensations, thoughts — is "seen" and therefore not the seer (DDV, vv. 1–5). What remains is ***Sakshin***, witness-consciousness — irreducible to matter and closer to Advaita's first-person route against physicalism than devotional VC passages alone (see §3.2, §5.5, §6.3).

> **“This body, O son of Kunti, is called the field; he who knows it is called the knower of the field.”**
> *- BG, 13.1*
>
> **“Know also that I am the Knower of the field in all fields, and the knowledge of the field also am I.”**
> *- BG, 13.2*

In the *Mandukya* analysis, *turiya* — the fourth, witness beyond waking, dream, and deep sleep — plays the same structural role: not another state among states, but the awareness in which states appear (MU, vv. 3–7; §2.2). At liberation, that witness is discovered as **non-personal Brahman** — one partless awareness without a second. Madhyasth Darshan agrees that the seer is not the seen body or brain-state, but locates the irreducible knower in **immortal *jeevan*** with active *gyan udghatan* (§1.11), not in a universal Self that finally absorbs all individuality (§5.5).

2.7 Conservation, origination, and temporality

Brahman does not begin: it is beginningless, partless, actionless, non-dual — outside temporal becoming (VC, v. 393). The universe as name-form has origination at the empirical level, but its ultimate truth is Brahman. Advaita’s classical cosmology treats *vyavahara* as **beginningless** — creation and dissolution cycle without a first moment — so the empirical world is not a fleeting illusion in the manner of a private error (*pratibhasika*).

Advaita does not devote a separate chapter to *kaal*, but its framework implies a sharp division. At ***paramartha***, only Brahman is absolutely real; temporality belongs to the empirical order. At ***vyavahara***, past, present, and future, birth and death, and causal succession are operationally valid — the world is law-governed and shared (§2.3) — yet finally sublated when Brahman alone is known.

The *Mandukya* analysis of waking, dream, and deep sleep (§2.2) is a first-person route into how temporal **states** appear and are witnessed; the witness (*turiya*) is not another state among them. Madhyasth Darshan accepts the reality of cyclical development and unit-activity across orders (§1.4–1.5) and refuses to sublate the world at the highest realization; its account of *kaal* as duration of activity (§1.4) is therefore closer to a **realist** temporal ontology at every order, while still denying that time is a substance independent of activity. Comparison with Advaita’s *trikaal* language and with Madhyasth Darshan’s *trikaalabadh* coexistence claim (SB, p. 48) is developed in [*Nature-Of-Time*] (§2.2, §4).

2.8 Liberation and the knowledge path

Liberation (*moksha*) is not dissolution or merger of a real individual into Brahman. The jiva was never a separate entity; realization is **recognition of pre-existing identity** with Brahman, in which the illusion of separate individuality is dispelled. The classical identity formula is *tat tvam asi* — "That thou art" (CU 6.8.7, with Śaṅkara's bhāṣya); BS 1.1.2 treats the same doctrine systematically. VC compresses the pedagogy:

> **"There is neither death nor birth, neither a bound nor a struggling soul, neither a seeker after Liberation nor a liberated one – this is the ultimate truth."**
> *- VC, v. 574*
>
> **"The Supreme Brahman is, like the sky, pure, absolute, infinite, motionless and changeless, devoid of interior or exterior, the One Existence, without a second, and one's own Self."**
> *- VC, v. 393*

Advaita inherits the classical analysis of valid knowledge (*pramana*). For the supreme truth of non-duality, **verbal testimony** (*shabda*) — the revealed word of the Upanishads, processed through reasoning and meditation — is finally competent; perception and inference operate within the subject-object duality to be transcended. The supreme path is classically threefold: hearing the scriptures (*shravana*), reasoning over them (*manana*), and sustained meditation (*nididhyasana*), under a qualified teacher. First-person discrimination (*drig-drishya-viveka*, DDV) complements scripture by negating everything that presents itself as an object until only witnessing awareness remains. Full epistemological comparison: Knowledge, Knower, and Known §2.

Shankara's *Vivekachudamani* insists on ethical discipline as prerequisite to knowledge (VC, vv. 17–19). Ethics at *vyavahara* is developed as the section capstone in §2.9.

2.9 Ethics, *loka-sangraha*, and what realization evidences

Advaita's charge that the world is *mithya* at *paramartha* does not make ethics untenable at the level where life is actually lived. At *vyavahara*, ethics and compassion remain fully valid; realization of non-duality deepens rather than weakens them. The Bhagavad Gita, in Shankara's commentary, grounds social responsibility in ***loka-sangraha*** — holding the world together — and ordained duty:

> **"Perform your bounden duty, for action is superior to inaction."**
> *- BG, 3.8 (Shankara's commentary: niyatam kuru karma; the enlightened still act for the welfare of the world)*

What Advaita **provisions** at the empirical order must be distinguished from what realization **evidences** at *paramartha*. Ethics, scripture, causal law, and compassionate action prepare the mind for *brahma-jnana*; they are binding where humans actually live. None of this guarantees that the world retains **final** ontological weight at the highest truth — that dispute is with Madhyasth Darshan's *jagat satat* (§1.12, §5.7).

Domain	Valid at *vyavahara*	Status at *paramartha*
Ethics and duty	Binding; deepens with realization (VC, vv. 17–19; BG 3.8)	Sublated as means; non-dual identity remains
World and nature	Law-governed, shared, beginningless cosmology	*Mithya* — dependent appearance
Individual self	Real as embodied jiva under *upadhi*	Identical with Brahman; separateness dispelled
Relationships and society	*Loka-sangraha*, ordained action for world-welfare	Not ultimately separate from Brahman
Time and change	Past, present, future, birth and death operationally valid	Sublated when timeless Self is known

Realization **evidences** identity with Brahman — the dispelled illusion of separate individuality, not Madhyasth Darshan's four outcomes of resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, and co-existence (§1.13). The enlightened still act for world-welfare at *vyavahara*; what changes at *paramartha* is ontological status, not the possibility of ethical living. Madhyasth Darshan's counter-reply — that robust ethics and beginningless *vyavahara* do not settle **final** world-realness — is developed in §6.3.

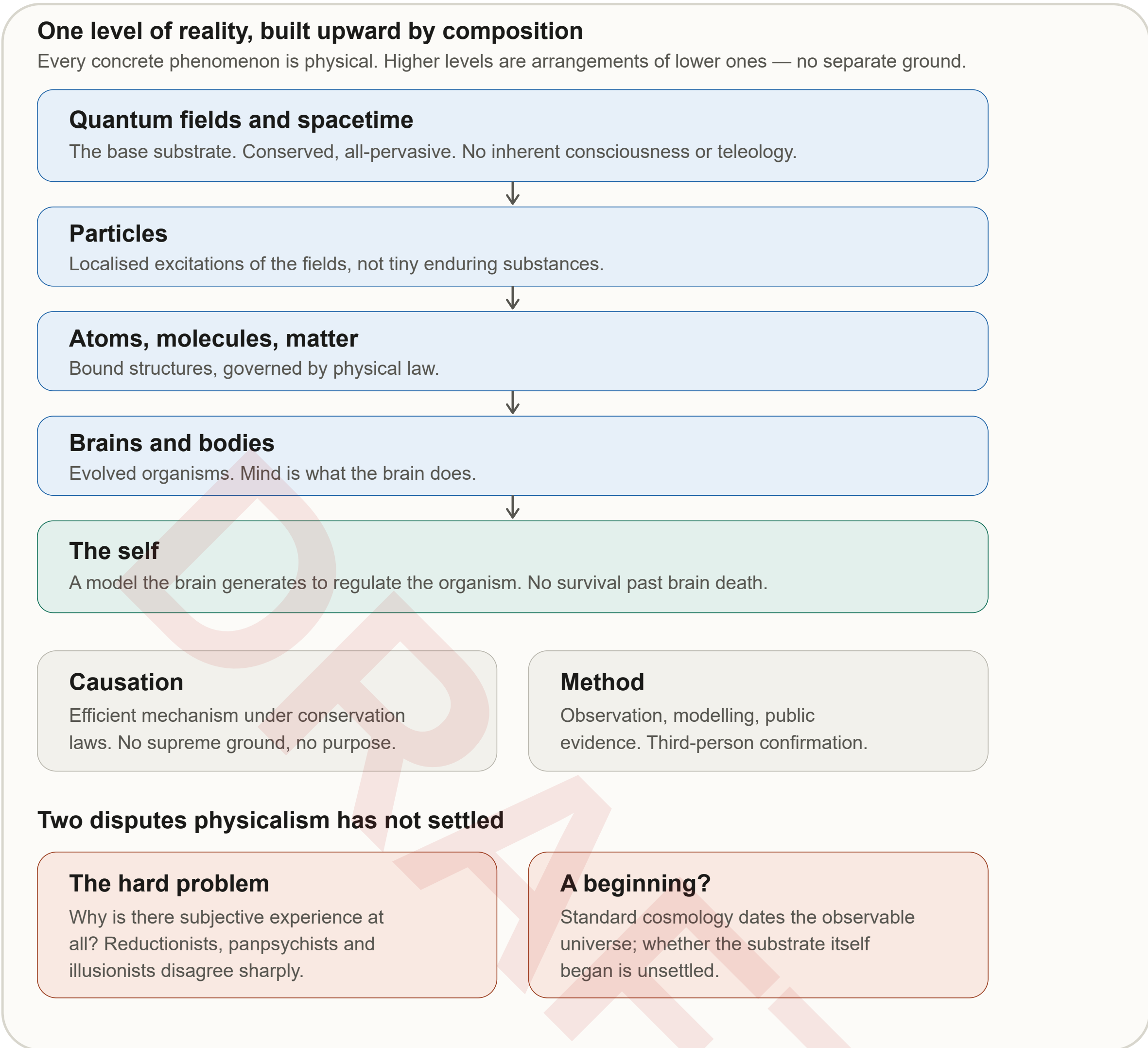
3. Modern Philosophical Approaches

Modern Western philosophy takes **physical nature as baseline** and disputes how mind, self, value, and the world's final status fit within it. The dominant materialist line holds that consciousness emerges from matter; metaphysical idealism has held the reverse. SB records that neither one-way emergence has been observed — what is evident is **coexistence**:

> **"In this course, metaphysical thought has held that matter arises from consciousness, whereas materialist thought has maintained that consciousness emerges from matter. Both ideologies have proposed numerous arguments, practices, and experiments in support of their claims. Yet, neither has matter been seen emerging from consciousness, nor consciousness emerging from matter. What is evident is that consciousness and matter are inseparably present."**
> *- SB, p. 48*

Madhyasth Darshan's own title — *Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad* (*Resolution Centred Materialism*) — reframes rather than abandons materialism. Against **dialectical materialism**, which treats struggle as the engine of history and science, SB proposes an orderliness-centred materialism in which nature remains real, saturated in Omnipresence, and oriented toward resolution rather than perpetual conflict (SB, pp. 8, 44). The Western debates below are the philosophical context that framing answers.

The account proceeds in layers. It begins with **physicalist ontology** — what exists on a matter-first picture — then states the **hard problem** and the **responses** physicalists offer (panpsychism, emergentism, illusionism, eliminativism). **Personal identity** and **persistence of the self** follow. **Origination, conservation, and world realism** treat whether what exists begins and whether the world retains final weight. **Alternative Western ontologies** supply historical analogues to ground-and-units coexistence. The section closes with **method and evidential stakes**. The physicalist architecture is summarised in the figure below; comparative detail on time and cosmology is in *Nature of Time* and §4.



3.1 Physicalist ontology: what exists

> **“I take physicalism to be the view that every real, concrete phenomenon in the universe is…physical.”**
> *- Strawson 2006, p. 2*

On this view, what exists are physical things, events, fields, organisms, brains, and processes. Minds and selves are not separate substances but **functions, organizations, models, or processes** of physical systems. Reductive physicalism holds that mental descriptions reduce without remainder to physical descriptions; non-reductive physicalism allows autonomous mental or functional levels while insisting that every concrete instance is still physical.

Methodological naturalism extends the picture into inquiry: the methods of the natural sciences — observation, experiment, modelling, public replication — are the standard for settling factual claims about the world. **Scientific realism** treats the physical world as **mind-independent** and law-governed: electrons, fields, and brains are not mere useful fictions but the furniture reality is made of, even when descriptions revise with theory change. Constructivist and instrumentalist variants soften that claim; they remain minority positions within mainstream analytic philosophy.

Physicalism also asserts **causal closure**: every physical event has a sufficient physical cause, so no non-physical entity injects energy or intention into the nervous system (Kim 2005). That closure is what makes immortal *jeevan* working through the body a live dispute: if the brain is a closed physical system, a distinct sentient unit cannot be an independent causal partner without violating conservation or epiphenomenalism. Madhyasth Darshan locates *jeevan* as the sentient unit that works through the body, not as a ghost in the machine — but the physicalist still demands a third-person account of how that partnership is possible (§3.4, §6.4).

3.2 The hard problem and the first-person datum

> **"The really hard problem of consciousness is the problem of experience. When we think and perceive, there is a whir of information-processing, but there is also a subjective aspect."**
> *- Chalmers 1995, p. 3*
>
> **"It is widely agreed that experience arises from a physical basis, but we have no good explanation of why and how it so arises."**
> *- Chalmers 1995, p. 3*
>
> **"the fact that an organism has conscious experience at all means, basically, that there is something it is like to be that organism."**
> *- Nagel 1974, p. 1*

The hard problem is not whether brains correlate with experience — they do — but why any physical process should have an **inside** at all. Advaita's DDV offers a complementary first-person route: whatever can be observed — body, sensations, thoughts — is "seen" and therefore not the seer (DDV, vv. 1–5; §2.6). Madhyasth Darshan reads the explanatory gap as evidence that matter-only ontology is **incomplete**; physicalists often treat it as philosophically non-decisive — a gap in current theory, not proof of extra-physical being (§6.2.1, §6.4).

Some philosophers split the difference through **property dualism**: experience may be an irreducible property of certain physical systems while the laws governing matter remain intact. That fork preserves law-governed physics but adds a primitive experiential aspect Chalmers-style accounts find unavoidable. Madhyasth Darshan does not map cleanly onto property dualism: active *chaitanya* belongs to constitutionally complete *jeevan*, not to every complex physical system, and *satta* as *gyan* is not a property of particles (§1.11).

3.3 Physicalist responses: panpsychism, emergentism, illusionism

Physicalists who take the hard problem seriously divide into several families. **Panpsychist physicalism** (Strawson 2006) insists that experience cannot emerge from wholly non-experiential matter:

> **"Full recognition of the reality of experience, then, is the obligatory starting point for any remotely realistic version of physicalism."**
> *- Strawson 2006, p. 2*
>
> **"Experiential phenomena cannot be emergent from wholly non-experiential phenomena."**
> *- Strawson 2006, p. 12*
>
> **"Real physicalism, realistic physicalism, entails panpsychism."**
> *- Strawson 2006, p. 12*

This is closer to Madhyasth Darshan than reductive physicalism, since both refuse experience-from-dead-matter. Strawson's anti-emergence principle presses on the *gathanpurnata* account: if experience cannot emerge from the wholly non-experiential, sentience at completeness must be **actualized from an ever-present ground**, not produced from nothing — the latency reading developed in §6.6. Madhyasth Darshan differs in scope: it does not say every particle is a subject; active sentience is the status of constitutionally complete atoms only.

Panpsychism's **combination problem** bears directly on that restriction. If micro-experientiality is primitive, how do micro-subjects combine into a unified macro-subject? Strawson and other panpsychists leave this wound open; integrated information theory addresses it through structural integration, at the cost of pan-experiential commitments Madhyasth Darshan rejects (§4.2). Madhyasth Darshan's answer is different in kind: **one constitutionally complete atom is already the sentient unit** — *jeevan* is not assembled from many micro-minds but is a self-maintaining composite whose completeness is functional indivisibility (§1.9–1.10). Whether that avoids the combination problem or relocates it to the threshold itself is examined in §6.6.

Emergentism offers a middle path: new properties appear at organisational thresholds — digestion from chemistry, life from biochemistry, mind from neural complexity. **Weak emergence** treats higher-level patterns as real but dependent on lower-level physics;

strong emergence would add causally novel properties irreducible to microphysics. Threshold grammar — a structural condition producing a qualitative register — is shared by emergentism, integrated information theory, and *gathanpurnata* (§6.6). Madhyasth Darshan denies **strong** emergence from dead matter while accepting qualitative change at constitutional completeness; latency names ever-present *gyan* in *satta* actualized at the threshold, not a new experiential ingredient from nothing.

At the opposite pole, **illusionism** (Frankish 2016) and **eliminative materialism** (Dennett 1991; Churchland 1986) preserve physicalism by denying or re-describing the datum the hard problem presses:

> **"Another approach, which holds that phenomenal consciousness is an illusion and aims to explain why it seems to exist."**
> *- Frankish 2016, p. 1*
>
> **"illusionists deny the existence of phenomenal consciousness properly so-called, but do not deny the existence of a form of consciousness"**
> *- Frankish 2016, p. 8*

Illusionists retain access-consciousness, self-report, and functional control while treating "what it is like" as a misdescription of introspective models. Eliminativists go further: folk-psychological categories such as belief and desire may fail to refer, to be replaced by neuroscience. Madhyasth Darshan treats experience, valuation, aspiration, and realization as activities of *jeevan*, not brain-model illusions. These views matter because they show how far naturalism will go to preserve a physicalist ontology — and because predictive-processing accounts (§4.1) offer a more sophisticated functionalist reply than bare elimination.

3.4 The self: personal identity and persistence

Physicalism's answer to "does the individual self begin or end with the body?" is typically **yes**, in some version. The self is a biological and cognitive achievement — developing through embodiment, memory, and social recognition — and ceasing when brain function ends. **Personal identity** theory asks what, if anything, makes a person the same individual over time.

Locke's classical account ties identity to **psychological continuity** — memory and connectedness of consciousness — rather than to sameness of material particles. Parfit's later work argues that what matters in survival is psychological connectedness and continuity, not a further fact of identity: there is no deep entity beyond the stream of mental states that must persist (Parfit 1984; SEP Personal Identity). On reductionist readings, the question "is this the same *jeevan* after death?" has no fact of the matter beyond causal and psychological links — which bodily death breaks.

Substance views — rational soul as form of the body (§3.6.1), simple monads (§3.6.3) — preserve an enduring individual bearer. Madhyasth Darshan's *jeevan* aligns with substance pluralism: a constitutionally complete, immortal unit that works through the body and persists across bodily death (§§1.10–1.12). Against physicalism, the dispute is not only metaphysical but **causal**: if the physical domain is closed, a non-physical *jeevan* is either epiphenomenal or a violation of closure. Self-model, predictive-processing, and integrated-information accounts in cognitive science (§§4.1–4.2) explain the **sense** of self without positing an immortal unit; Madhyasth Darshan's counter is that regulation and representation do not settle what **works through** the brain (§6.4, §6.6).

3.5 Origination, conservation, and world realism

Western philosophy asks whether **what exists** had a beginning and whether **particulars** endure through change. Mainstream physicalism holds that local systems — organisms, stars, civilisations — begin and end, while fundamental physics may or may not require a cosmic beginning (§4.3). **Conservation** principles in physics treat certain quantities as preserved through transformation — a structural parallel to Madhyasth Darshan's claim that *vastu* persists through *roop*-change (§1.12, §4.4), though the categories differ.

Scientific realism answers "is the world finally real?" with **yes** for the physical universe: tables, fields, and brains are real mind-independent items suitable for public study. **Idealism** (Berkeley and successors) makes reality depend on perception or mind; **nihilism** denies that anything ultimately exists or matters. Both are outliers in contemporary analytic ontology but sharpen the stakes: Madhyasth Darshan's perpetual world (*jagat satat*) is neither mind-dependent appearance nor physical reduction alone — units and Omnipresence are co-eternally real (§1.12).

Philosophy of **time** adds a further fork. Block-universe **eternalism** treats past, present, and future as equally real coordinates; **presentism** privileges the present. Relational theories deny time as an independent container — time is the order of change among things. Madhyasth Darshan's *kaal* as duration of unit-activity is structurally closer to relational and process views than to block eternalism (*Nature of Time* §3). Cosmological questions about a beginningless substrate are developed in §4.3; the philosophical point here is that Western ontology has **no consensus** on whether existence as a whole begins, even when particular configurations do.

3.6 Alternative Western ontologies

Before the twentieth-century focus on mind and brain, Western metaphysics developed several **ground-plus-particulars** schemes that map partially onto Madhyasth Darshan's co-existence. They are ordered here from form-matter compounds through monism and pluralism to neutral ground — not as a historical timeline but as a ladder of analogues for §5.3–5.4.

3.6.1 Hylomorphism and soul-as-form

Aristotelian–Thomistic **hylomorphism** maps form (*forma*) onto matter (*materia*) so that a substance is the compound of both — not mere aggregation. Aquinas treats the rational soul as the **form of the living body** (*anima forma corporis*), giving a joint ontology of soul-and-body that parallels Madhyasth Darshan's *jeevan–shareer* joint form and the four-aspect unit signature (form, properties, essential nature, *dharma*) as what a unit **is** (§1.3). *Gathanpurnata* resembles substantial completion: a definite constitution at which a unit's essential nature is fully actualized. The divergences are sharp: Madhyasth Darshan's plural, immortal *jeevan* units, beginningless coexistence with *satta*, and saturation are not Aristotelian prime matter plus a single rational soul per body; yet the soul-as-form debate is a nearer cousin than process philosophy on individual persistence (SEP Form and Matter; Aquinas ST I, q. 75–76).

3.6.2 Spinoza: substance and modes

Spinoza's **substance monism** offers a closer analogue to *satta*-with-units than neutral monism. For Spinoza, one infinite substance (*Deus sive Natura*) has infinitely many **modes** — finite particulars expressing the one substance under different attributes (thought and extension). Madhyasth Darshan likewise keeps a pervasive ground and countless real units, but the contrast is decisive: Spinoza has **one** substance whose modes are not ontologically on a par with the whole; Madhyasth Darshan has **co-eternal** *satta* and *ikai*, each real in its own right, bound by saturation rather than modal expression of a single substance (Spinoza, *Ethics*, Part I, Props. 14–15; Part II, Def. 3). Spinoza's parallelism of thought and extension also differs from Madhyasth Darshan's tiered intelligibility: active *chaitanya* belongs only to *jeevan*, not to every mode of extension.

3.6.3 Leibniz: monads and harmony

Leibnizian **monads** offer a tighter analogue to plural immortal *jeevan* than Whitehead's occasions. Monads are simple, individual substances that mirror the whole from their perspective, do not interact by efficient causation but harmonize, and do not naturally perish. That plurality-with-harmony and individual immortality align structurally with many distinct *jeevan*-clouds saturated in Omnipresence (MVD, p. 13). The contrast: monads are windowless and perception-based; *jeevan* works through bodies in definite *sambandh* and fulfils relationships in nature's orders (Leibniz, *Monadology*, §§1–14, 78–81).

3.6.4 Process philosophy: occasions and becoming

Whitehead's **process philosophy** shares relational realism and refusal of nature bifurcation. His basic units are "actual entities" — "drops of experience, complex and interdependent" (Whitehead 1929, p. 28). The key contrast remains persistence: Whitehead's occasions are momentary and "perpetually perish" subjectively, gaining "objective immortality" only as data for successors (Whitehead 1929, p. 44), whereas Madhyasth Darshan's *jeevan* is a persisting immortal individual. Process metaphysics also treats time as internal to becoming — a partial affinity with activity-based *kaal* (§3.5; *Nature of Time* §3.3).

> **“Actual entities ‘perpetually perish’ subjectively, but are immortal objectively.”**
> *- Whitehead 1929, p. 44*

3.6.5 Neutral monism: common ground

Neutral monism (Russell, Mach) resembles Omnipresence as a reality that is neither mind nor matter but common ground. Russell holds that mind and matter are “composed of a neutral-stuff which, in isolation, is neither mental nor material” (Russell 1921, Lecture I). Mach likewise denies any “rift between the psychical and the physical”: “There is but one kind of elements, out of which this supposed inside and outside are formed” (Mach 1914, Ch. XIV). The contrast: neutral monism typically builds mind and matter out of the neutral stuff, whereas Madhyasth Darshan keeps Omnipresence non-transforming and lets units be real in their own right rather than constructed from the ground.

> **“Both mind and matter are composed of a neutral-stuff which, in isolation, is neither mental nor material.”**
> *- Russell 1921, Lecture I*
>
> **“There is no rift between the psychical and the physical, no inside and outside… There is but one kind of elements, out of which this supposed inside and outside are formed.”**
> *- Mach 1914, Ch. XIV*

3.7 Method, evidence, and what philosophy establishes

Modern Western philosophy does not speak with one voice, but a typical physicalist constellation answers the study’s framing questions as follows:

Question	Typical Western philosophical answer
What is existence?	Concrete physical reality — fields, spacetime, organisms — studied empirically; some add experience as fundamental (panpsychism) or neutral ground (neutral monism).
What exists?	Physical entities and their organisations; minds as processes; disputed whether experience is reducible, fundamental, or illusory.
Does what exists begin?	Particular systems begin and end; whether fundamentals had a first moment is unsettled (§3.5, §4.3).
Does the individual self begin?	The self develops with body and brain; psychological continuity does not survive bodily death on standard physicalist accounts (§3.4).

Question	Typical Western philosophical answer
Is the world finally real?	Yes, for scientific realism — the physical world is mind-independent; idealism and world-as-illusion are minority views.
Method of knowing	Observation, argument, public evidence; first-person datum acknowledged but not treated as existence-proof for immortal units.

What philosophy **has** established, on Madhyasth Darshan's reading, is a high **evidential bar** and a persistent **exposed point**: the hard problem shows that reductive matter-only accounts leave experience unexplained. What it has **not** established is immortal *jeevan*, constitutional completeness, or post-death continuity — an explanatory gap is not an existence proof (§6.4). Predictive processing and self-model theories (§4.1) deepen the physicalist reply without settling the ontological dispute.

Mainstream **science** inherits this physicalist baseline and adds measurement, formal models, and institutional replication — the subject of §4.

4. Modern Scientific Approaches

Mainstream science inherits the physicalist baseline of §3 and adds **measurement, formal models, and institutional replication**. Where philosophy disputes mind, self, and world-realness in argument, science operationalises those disputes through instruments, datasets, and peer review. SB records that humans seek to live with evidence through experimentation, behaviour, and experience — not through argument alone:

> **"Humans inherently seek to live with evidence through experimentation, behaviour, and experience. They desire to achieve comprehensive resolution — across various aspects, perspectives, directions, dimensions, and contexts of time and place."**
> *- SB, p. 44*

Madhyasth Darshan treats public science as one powerful leg of that evidence-seeking: powerful on mechanism, prediction, and correction. It adds **realization and conduct** as further evidence of understanding — the epistemic frame developed in Knowledge, Knower, and Known. JV notes that the human body is provisioned to **evidence** understanding, not merely to house brain activity (JV, p. 59).

The account proceeds in layers. It begins with **mind, self, and predictive processing** in neuroscience, then states **consciousness-science** threshold rivals (IIT, autopoiesis, competing programs). **Cosmology** treats whether the universe began. **Quantum fields and conservation** address what persists through transformation. **Spacetime and entropy** contrast physical time and disorder with *kaal* and *vyavastha*. **Evolution and ecology** treat adaptation and cooperation as biological mechanisms. The section closes with **method and**

what science establishes. Detailed time physics is in [*Nature of Time*]; critique of scientific limits is in §6.4.

4.1 Mind, self, and predictive processing

Self-model theories in cognitive science (Metzinger 2003) build on the physicalist premise that the self is not an immortal unit but a **predictive model** the brain generates to regulate the organism:

> **“minimal selfhood emerges as the result”**
> *- Limanowski and Blankenburg 2013, p. 1*
>
> **“these accounts propose to ‘understand the elusive sense of minimal self in terms of having internal models that successfully predict or match the sensory consequences of our own movement, our intentions in action, and our sensory input’.”**
> *- Limanowski and Blankenburg 2013, p. 3*

The most developed recent form is **predictive processing** and **active inference**: the brain as a hierarchically deep generative model that minimizes prediction error (surprise) by updating beliefs and guiding action (Friston 2010; Clark 2016). On this view, valuation, aspiration, the sense of being a continuous self, and the felt reality of the world are not dismissed as mere illusion; they are **functionally real control structures** — layered expectations that keep the organism viable. Seth (2021) extends the picture: conscious selfhood is the brain’s “best guess” about its own embodiment, a controlled hallucination tuned by interoceptive and sensorimotor evidence.

For Madhyasth Darshan this is nearly the opposite of the *jeevan* ontology: the self is a real sentient unit using the body, not a model generated by embodied prediction. Science’s operational criterion for when that regulative process **ends** is **brain death** — irreversible loss of whole-brain function. On that standard, the person ceases when neural integration fails; there is no post-death survival of the self for medicine to measure. Madhyasth Darshan answers the self-model rival through **latency**: sentience is actualized from the ever-present ground at constitutional completeness, not generated as a new ingredient from dead matter (§6.6). Predictive models explain **how** a body self-regulates; they do not settle **whether** the regulator is only neural tissue or a distinct *jeevan* working through the brain (§6.4.3, §6.5).

4.2 Consciousness science: IIT, autopoiesis, and rival programs

Integrated Information Theory (IIT) proposes that consciousness corresponds to integrated information (Φ) in a system, with a quantitative threshold producing a qualitative difference — “an experience is a maximally irreducible conceptual structure” (Tononi 2012). IIT is a useful physicalist mirror of threshold grammar: like *gathanpurnata*, it ties consciousness to a structural condition. The contrasts are decisive: IIT is pan-experiential at the fundamental level in many formulations, operational and measurement-oriented, and silent on immortal individual units or coexistential ground; Madhyasth Darshan restricts **active** sentience to constitutionally complete reflector atoms and locates latency in *satta* as *gyan* (§§1.11, 6.6).

Autopoiesis (Maturana and Varela) treats living organization as a self-producing network that maintains its boundary and identity through continuous metabolism — "a machine organized as a network of processes of production of components" that "continuously regenerate and realize the network that produces them" (Maturana and Varela 1980, p. 78). This parallels Madhyasth Darshan's emphasis on self-maintaining constitutional completeness and bio-order cyclicality, but autopoiesis describes organizational closure in biology, not the ontological saturation of units in *satta* or the latency of sentience at *gathanpurnata*.

Contemporary **consciousness science** has no settled account. Competing programs — integrated information, global neuronal workspace, higher-order theory, recurrent processing, and others — offer different structural criteria for when experience is present. Adversarial tests have partly supported and partly challenged leading theories without producing consensus. For this study, the point is structural: science shares **threshold grammar** with *gathanpurnata* but offers no third-person metric for latency in *satta* or for immortal *jeevan* (§6.6).

4.3 Cosmology and cosmic beginnings

The **ΛCDM** standard model treats the observable universe as expanding from a hot dense state roughly **13.8 billion years ago** — a cosmic beginning for the universe we can observe. That model is extraordinarily successful on large-scale structure, nucleosynthesis, and the cosmic microwave background. It does not by itself answer whether **existence as a whole** began, or only this cosmic epoch.

Several **non-singular** research programs explore a beginningless physical substrate from which local universes or phases arise. **Loop quantum cosmology** replaces the initial singularity with a "bounce" from a prior contracting phase (Ashtekar and Singh 2011). **Penrose's conformal cyclic cosmology** posits successive aeons, each with its own big bang (Penrose 2010). **Eternal inflation** treats our observable patch as one bubble in a potentially infinite multiverse (Guth 2007). These are competing speculative programs, not consensus — the most this comparison claims is **conceptual resonance** with Madhyasth Darshan's claim that nature (*prakriti*) is perpetual (*satat*), not proof that *jagat satat* is established by cosmology (§1.12, §6.2.8).

4.4 Quantum fields, particles, and conservation

Particle–antiparticle annihilation and pair creation are not passages into or out of absolute non-being. In quantum field theory, particles are localized excitations of conserved, all-pervasive fields, and annihilation transforms one excitation (matter) into another (radiation) under strict conservation laws (Weinberg 1995). This is broadly consonant with Madhyasth

Darshan's claim that fundamental reality (*vastu*) is conserved while configurations (*roop*) transform (§1.12) — though the alignment must be handled with care.

What persists in QFT are **field configurations** and conserved quantities; a "particle" is a localized excitation, not a tiny enduring substance. Madhyasth Darshan's *vastu* names an underlying reality that survives every *roop*-change in countable units with *dharma* saturated in Omnipresence. The parallel is structural, not identity of category: fields are mathematical-physical entities governed by equations, not bounded *ikai* in coexistence.

Comparing *satta* to a physical field is misleading for the same reason. A dynamical field carries energy-momentum, exerts force, and propagates waves — nothing like the actionless (*kriya-shunya*), non-transforming *satta* (§1.2). The nearest physical analogue — non-dynamical background geometry or the quantum vacuum ground state — captures only that units depend on a uniform ground; it drops the darshan's second half: uniform energy stays unmanifest without unit activity (§1.2). Energy conservation itself is subtle in General Relativity: it is tied, via Noether's theorem, to time-symmetry that need not hold globally in an expanding spacetime (Carroll 2010).

4.5 Spacetime, entropy, and order

Modern physics treats **spacetime** as a dynamical entity — it can expand, curve, and in some models exhibit local beginnings. Madhyasth Darshan treats *kaal* as the **duration of unit-activity**, numerically reckoned by humans within existence (§1.4; SB, pp. 65, 251; MVD, pp. 34, 195) — not an independent cosmic container. Omnipresence is timeless as non-transforming ground. The contrast is over whether temporality belongs to the ground of reality or only to transforming units, and over whether spacetime is fundamental physics or derivative of measurement conventions on activity. Relational and process philosophies of time (§3.6.4; §3.5) share some structural affinity with activity-based *kaal*; block-universe eternalism does not. Comparative detail: *Nature-Of-Time*.

Thermodynamic entropy describes a statistical arrow toward disorder in closed systems. Madhyasth Darshan asserts inherent **orderliness** (*vyavastha*) at every order, with development toward greater organization when units are in their natural state. These are not straightforward opposites — biological and ecological systems can increase local order at the cost of entropy elsewhere — but they use different notions of "order." The second law neither supports nor refutes coexistence orderliness.

4.6 Evolution, ecology, and cooperation

Natural selection is mainstream biology's mechanism for adaptation: heritable variation plus differential reproduction produces organisms fitted to their environments. On this picture, bodies, brains, and behavioural strategies — including cooperation — are **products of evolutionary history**, not eternal units with ontologically fixed *dharma*.

Ecology treats organisms as nodes in interdependent networks: energy flows, nutrient cycles, symbiosis, and competition. **Cooperation** among conspecifics and across species is widely studied as an evolved strategy — kin selection, reciprocity, mutualism — not as ontologically real *mulya* (*value*) fulfilled in definite *sambandh* (§1.6). Madhyasth Darshan does not deny biological interdependence; it denies that ecological cooperation **replaces** inherent value-recognition and fulfilment at the knowledge order. Science explains how cooperative behaviour arises; MD claims complementarity and essentiality-as-value are **already structurally real** in coexistence.

Against all of these, Madhyasth Darshan makes stronger metaphysical claims: coexistence is eternal, units are not annihilated, and *jeevan* is immortal. That eternalism is **consistent with** conservation principles and beginningless cosmological models; individual immortality and constitutional completeness are **distinct commitments** examined in §6.2.

4.7 Method, evidence, and what science establishes

Modern science does not speak with one voice across every specialty, but a typical physical-science constellation answers the study's framing questions as follows:

Question	Typical scientific answer
What is existence?	Dynamical spacetime, quantum fields, and their excitations — studied through observation, experiment, and mathematical models.
What exists?	Matter, energy, fields, organisms, brains; minds as functional/processual features of neural systems.
Does what exists begin?	The observable universe ~13.8 Ga on ΛCDM; whether any substrate is beginningless is unsettled (§4.3).
Does the individual self begin?	Self develops with brain and body; **brain death** ends the person operationally; no measured post-death continuity (§4.1).
Is the world finally real?	Yes — the physical world is mind-independent and law-governed, publicly testable.
Method of knowing	Observation, instrumentation, modelling, replication, peer review; third-person confirmation.

What science **has** established is precise mechanism, prediction, and correction across domains from particle physics to neuroscience. What it **has not** established — on Madhyasth Darshan's reading — is immortal *jeevan*, constitutional completeness at *gathanpurnata*, or post-death continuity of a sentient unit. An explanatory gap in the hard problem (§3.2) is not an existence proof for *jeevan*; predictive accuracy alone does not settle whether the regulator is only neural or a distinct unit working through the brain (§6.4, §6.5). The comparative synthesis begins in §5.

5. Comparison

5.1 Comparative summary

Question	Madhyasth Darshan	Advaita Vedanta	Modern physicalist approaches
What is existence?	Eternally present coexistence: Omnipresence plus all units held in it.	Brahman / Existence alone, one without a second.	Concrete physical reality, studied empirically.
What exists?	Omnipresence and real units, sentient and insentient.	Brahman alone (absolutely); world *mithya* at *paramartha*.	Usually the physical; experience disputed.
Does it begin?	No — what exists does not come from non-existence; bodies and configurations do.	Brahman does not begin; name-form at *vyavahara*.	Particular systems begin and end; cosmology unsettled.
Does the individual self begin?	*Jeevan* does not begin at birth or die with the body.	*Jiva* is ultimately Brahman; separate individuality dispelled at realization (VC, vv. 244, 574).	Self develops as biological/cognitive process.
What is time?	Duration of unit-activity; human numerical reckoning within existence; *satta* timeless as ground (§1.4).	Brahman beyond temporal becoming; time valid at *vyavahara*, sublated at *paramartha*.	Spacetime as dynamical physical structure; philosophy of time contested.
Is the world finally real?	Yes. "Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual."	Empirically valid but ultimately *mithya*.	Yes, as physical reality.
Method of knowing	Study, realization, behavior, experiment.	Scripture, reasoning, contemplative discrimination.	Observation, modelling, public evidence.
Ethical consequence	Humane conduct evidences understanding of coexistence.	Ethics prepares the mind for liberation.	Ethics via naturalism, social/normative theory.

5.2 Causal doctrine: *Satkaryavada*, *Vivartavada*, and Madhyasth Darshan

Causal doctrine is the deepest structural difference between the three systems — it determines how each tradition treats origination and beginninglessness (§5.1, "Does it begin?").

Advaita (Sankhya inheritance): *Satkaryavada* — the effect pre-exists in the cause (clay-pot, VC v. 251). At the empirical level, creation is *vivartavada*: apparent transformation of name-form on changeless Brahman — the effect is not a real transformation of the cause. Brahman does not change; multiplicity is projected through *Maya*.

Madhyasth Darshan: Denies single-material-cause reduction and linear efficient-cause chains. *Satta* is *mahakaran* (supreme sustaining cause), not efficient cause (§1.2). Units change through the single activity triad *shram–gati–parinam*, read toward completeness in sentient nature through projection, reflection, and *samadhan*, with circular activity, order-specific cyclicality, and *sanskar*-mediated human cycles. Conservation of *vastu* through *roop*-change resembles *parinamavada* at the unit level, but the full picture is not reducible to "*parinamavada*-like" alone.

Modern physicalism: Strict efficient causation — mechanism, fields, conservation laws. Origination of particular systems is compatible with a beginningless substrate (§4.3); no teleology or supreme ground.

Aspect	Advaita	Madhyasth Darshan	Modern physicalism
Effect in cause?	Yes (*satkaryavada*)	Units eternal; change is transformation within coexistence	Conservation laws; particles as field excitations
Cause transforms?	No (Brahman changeless; *vivarta*)	*Satta* non-transforming; units transform	Fields/spacetime dynamical
Origination vs change	Name-form originates at *vyavahara*; Brahman does not begin	No origination from *abhava*; development and awakening	Local systems begin/end; substrate unsettled

5.3 Entity categories compared

The entity matrix in §5.4 compares traditions that share a **grammar of enduring entities** — cosmic ground, individual self, material reality, relationships, causation, and ultimate purpose. **Buddhist** traditions, especially Madhyamaka, are omitted from that matrix **methodologically**, not because they are irrelevant. Madhyamaka denies intrinsic *svabhava* and *anatta* denies an enduring self; it does not answer "what entity type is the self?" within the same grammar — it challenges whether the table's categories apply at all. A Buddhist column would misrepresent Buddhism as offering parallel rows for ground and self when its sharpest pressure is against the table's presuppositions. **Anatta** and Nagarjuna's critique belong in

§6.2.2, where the gravest comparative threat to immortal distinct *jeevan* is engaged directly (see also §5.4 preamble).

Modern philosophy (§3):

1. **Cosmic Ground:** Form–matter compound (hylomorphism); one substance with modes (Spinoza); harmonized monads (Leibniz); neutral stuff (neutral monism); or creativity/becoming (process).
2. **Individual Self:** Soul-as-form of body (hylomorphism); simple monads (Leibniz); self-model (physicalism); or experiential monads (panpsychism).
3. **Material Reality:** Physical matter and energy; or the outer aspect of experiential units (panpsychism).
4. **Causation:** Formal and final causation (hylomorphism); pre-established harmony (Leibniz); efficient mechanism (physicalism); or creative concrescence (process).

Modern science (§4):

1. **Cosmic Ground:** Dynamic spacetime and quantum fields — no inherent consciousness or teleology.
2. **Individual Self:** Brain-generated cognitive agent; no post-death survival.
3. **Material Reality:** Localized field excitations; conserved under physical law.
4. **Causation & Order:** Physical causation, entropy, evolved ecological cooperation.

5.4 Entity comparison

The table compares primary entities across the four traditions developed in the body of the study. Abrahamic and Dvaita ontologies are outside scope. **Buddhist** traditions are excluded from the matrix for the methodological reasons stated in §5.3: Madhyamaka and *anatta* challenge the enduring-entity grammar the table presupposes rather than answering it in parallel columns. **Anatta** and Nagarjuna's *svabhava* critique are central to the ontology and are engaged at length in §6.2.2 — the proper venue for the tradition treated here as the gravest philosophical threat.

Entity Category / Attribute	Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Contemporary Philosophy (Process, Physicalist, Panpsychist)	Modern Science (Physics, CogSci, Cosmology)
Cosmic Ground	**Omnipresence (*Satta / Space*)**: Pervasive, formless, actionless energy (*kriya-shunya*). Inherent energy and regulation in units through saturation (*samprikt*); uniform energy manifests as activity only through units (§1.2).	**Brahman**: The single, non-dual absolute reality (*Sat-Chit-Ananda*). The world is *mithya* (dependent appearance) at *paramartha*.	**Form + Matter** (Hylomorphism): Substantial form actualizing matter. **Substance + modes** (Spinoza): One *Deus sive Natura*, finite modes. **Monad field** (Leibniz): Simple substances in harmony. **Creativity / God** (Process): Dynamic process. **Neutral Stuff** (Neutral Monism): Common element.	**Spacetime & Quantum Fields**: Dynamic, physical substrate. No inherent consciousness or teleology.

Entity Category / Attribute	Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Contemporary Philosophy (Process, Physicalist, Panpsychist)	Modern Science (Physics, CogSci, Cosmology)
Individual Self / Sentience	**Jeevan**: A constitutionally complete, immortal atom (*gathanpurna parmanu*). Many distinct, eternal *jeevan* exist.	**Jivatman / Atman**: Individuality (*jivatman*) is a *vyavahara* superimposition (VC, v. 244). The true Self (*Atman*) is identical to Brahman.	**Rational Soul as Form** (Hylomorphism): Form of the living body. **Monad** (Leibniz): Simple, mirroring, immortal substance. **Self-Model** (Physicalist): Evolved cognitive model. **Φ-threshold system** (IIT): Integrated information.	**Predictive Self / Cognitive Agent**: Brain-generated hierarchical model (§4.1). No survival post-death.
Material Reality / Body	**Jada Units / Shareer**: Real, perpetual, transforming matter. Composes the body, which acts as the vehicle for *jeevan*.	**Nama-Roopa / Mithya**: Form and name; robust at *vyavahara*; sublated at *paramartha*.	**Physical Matter**: The primary concrete reality (Physicalism); or the outer aspect of experiential units (Panpsychism).	**Matter & Energy**: Consolidated excitations of quantum fields. Governed by conservation laws. Perpetual in base fields.

Entity Category / Attribute	Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Contemporary Philosophy (Process, Physicalist, Panpsychist)	Modern Science (Physics, CogSci, Cosmology)
Relationships & Moral Order	**Coexistence / Complementarity**: Inherent, ontologically real values (*mulya*) and orderliness (*vyavastha*) through the regulation ladder (§1.7).	**Ethics at *vyavahara***: Valid to purify the mind; *loka-sangraha* (BG); sublated at *paramartha*.	**Social / Internal Relations**: Relationality constitutes the self (Process); or evolutionary strategies for survival (Physicalism).	**Ecology & Cooperation**: Interdependent biological networks. Cooperation is an evolved behavioral strategy.
Primary Causation	**Circular mutual causality (§§1.2–1.4)**: *Satta* as *mahakaran*; single *shram–gati–parinam* triad with sentient unfolding; circular activity; *sanskar*-mediated human cycles.	**Vivartavada**: Apparent transformation on changeless Brahman (*satkaryavada* background).	**Efficient / Creative Causation**: Physical mechanisms (Physicalism); or "concrescence" (Process).	**Physical Causation**: Mathematical laws, conservation, entropy.
Ultimate Purpose / Realization	**Awakening (*Jagriti*)**: Realization of coexistence, leading to resolved humane conduct (*manaviya aacharan*) in society.	**Liberation (*Moksha*)**: Recognition of identity with Brahman; illusion of separate self dispelled (VC, v. 574).	**Flourishing / Adaptation**: Cognitive adaptability (Physicalism); aesthetic intensity of experience (Process).	**Survival & Adaptation**: Natural selection; active inference / free-energy minimization (Friston 2010; §4.1); homeostasis.

5.5 The Sat-Chit-Ananda contrast, distributed

Advaita's Sat-Chit-Ananda and Madhyasth Darshan's coexistence can sound alike — both speak of being, consciousness, and fulfilment. The contrast is over what those words name and whether the world survives them.

For Advaita, *sat*, *chit*, *ananda* are three names for one ultimate reality without a second; the world is finally *mithya*. For Madhyasth Darshan, the same vocabulary is distributed across coexistence, not compressed into one subject:

Concept	Advaita Vedanta (Unified Non-Dualism)	Madhyasth Darshan (Distributed Coexistence)
Sat (Being)	Brahman alone is Sat; the world is a dependent appearance ultimately negated.	Beingness (*astitva*) is coexistence of formless Omnipresence and countless real units.
Chit (Consciousness)	Pure awareness, identical to the inner Self; the world of names/forms is inert.	Omnipresence is pervasive knowledge/condition-of-intelligibility (§1.11), but active sentience (*chaitanya*) belongs to the *jeevan* unit.
Ananda (Bliss)	Intrinsic nature of Brahman; sensory joy is a distorted reflection.	Harmony realized within the awakened *jeevan*, expressed as humane conduct.

The *chit* row and the DDV route sharpen a further fork. Both traditions refuse to reduce the first person to observed brain-states; both distinguish seer from seen. Advaita's *Sakshin* / *turiya*, once discriminated, is **Brahman itself** — impersonal, universal, and finally without a second knower. Madhyasth Darshan's knower is **constitutionally complete *jeevan***: many distinct units, each capable of *gyan udghatan* when awakened (§1.11). Against physicalism the two stand together; against each other the dispute is whether irreducible awareness is one or many, impersonal ground or immortal persons-in-coexistence.

Modern philosophy has no parallel formula: it may treat experience as physical, fundamental, or illusory, but it does not name existence as Sat-Chit-Ananda or as coexistence.

5.6 Is It Possible to Map Madhyasth Darshan to Advaita?

While the two systems arise from different core commitments (Advaita: non-dualism; Madhyasth Darshan: co-existentialism), four key entities in Advaita find close analogues or functional equivalents in Madhyasth Darshan. A fifth — *Pancha Kosha* — shares Upanishadic vocabulary only; it is not a structural entity map (item 5 below).

1. **Brahman corresponds to *Satta* (Omnipresence / Space)**
    - **Mapping:** Both are formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming, timeless, and actionless. Both serve as the ontological ground of everything.
    - **Divergence:** Advaita's Brahman is the *sole* absolute reality (*paramartha*), making the world an appearance (*mithya*). Madhyasth Darshan's *Satta* coexists with nature (*prakriti*); both are real. Brahman is awareness itself (*chit*), whereas

Satta is actionless energy (*kriya-shunya urja*)—the condition of intelligibility—while active sentience (*chaitanya*) belongs exclusively to the *jeevan* unit (§1.11).

2. **Paramatman / Atman corresponds to *Atma (in Jeevan) / Jeevan***
    - **Mapping:** Both point to the true, immortal, non-material reality of the self. Within the five-fold structure of *jeevan*, the *Atma* represents the innermost core of realization.
    - **Divergence:** Advaita holds that the true Self (*Atman*) is exactly identical to the single, universal Supreme Self (*Paramatman*). Madhyasth Darshan denies a single universal self; it holds that *jeevan* units are permanently distinct, multiple, and active.
3. **Jivatman (Jiva) corresponds to Deluded *Jeevan* (*Bhramit Jeevan*)**
    - **Mapping:** Both represent the individual embodied self experiencing the world, bound by ignorance (body-identification), and seeking liberation or resolution.
    - **Divergence:** In Advaita, the *jivatman–Paramatman* duality is maintained only at *vyavahara* due to conditioning (*upadhis*); upon liberation, the duality is seen to have been false — what remains is Brahman alone (CU 6.8.7; BS 1.1.2 with Śaṅkara's bhāṣya; VC, v. 244). For Madhyasth Darshan, individuality is ontologically real and eternal; realization (*jagriti*) resolves delusion but preserves the active, distinct individuality of the *jeevan*.
4. **Jagat / Nama-Roopa corresponds to Nature / Units (*Prakriti* / *Ikai*)**
    - **Mapping:** Both point to the physical universe of change, bodies, name, and form.
    - **Divergence:** In Advaita, the Jagat is ultimately *mithya* (dependent appearance) and sublated at the highest realization. In Madhyasth Darshan, the world of units is *satat* (perpetual) and eternally real.
5. **Pancha Kosha (Five Sheaths) — terminological echo only, not a structural map**
    - **Shared vocabulary:** Both traditions use five-layer (*kosha*) language drawn from the Upanishads — Advaita's Taittiriya stack (*annamaya* through *anandamaya*), Madhyasth Darshan's order-and-plane exposition (*pran kosha*, *vigyanmaya*, etc.; MVD, pp. 49–50; §1.10).
    - **Why this is not an entity analogue:** Madhyasth Darshan carries **two** five-fold structures that do not match Advaita's sheaths one-to-one. §1.10 names five inseparable **faculties within *jeevan*** — *mun*, *vritti*, *chitta*, *buddhi*, *atma* — as the inner sentient structure. §1.10 applies kosha terms to **developmental planes** (animal and deluded humans at four koshas; awakened humans at five including *vigyanmaya*), not to an anatomical stack parallel to *annamaya…anandamaya*. Advaita peels sheaths away to reveal the Self beneath (VC, vv. 210, 639) — not primarily through *neti-neti* (Brihadaranyaka Upanishad). Madhyasth Darshan

affirms layered human equipment to be harmonized in awakened living. The overlap is **terminological**, not ontological; listing koshas among the four structural analogues would overstate the parallel.

5.7 Unmappable Entities

Certain central entities and categories in Advaita Vedanta cannot be mapped to Madhyasth Darshan because they represent concepts that co-existentialism explicitly rejects:

1. **Maya (as an Ontological Power of Projection/Concealment)**
   - Advaita's *Maya* is the cosmic power that conceals Brahman (*avarana*) and projects the illusion of the world (*vikshepa*). Madhyasth Darshan has no equivalent cosmic power or substance of illusion. Ignorance (*agnyan* / *bhrama*) is not a force or substance but merely the temporary cognitive absence of understanding (lack of awakening), which is resolved through study and education.
2. **Adhyasa (Superimposition)**
   - In Advaita, the world is superimposed (*adhyasa*) on Brahman like a snake on a rope (BS 2.1.14 with Śaṅkara's bhāṣya; VC, v. 20). Madhyasth Darshan has no concept of ontological superimposition. The relationship between units and *Satta* is **saturation** (*samprikt*) — a real, mutual, non-reductive co-location: inherent energy and regulation in units through saturation; uniform energy at the ground and unit-activity manifest together (§1.2; SB, pp. 57, 62, 69) — not a projection or false attribution. Do not confuse this with Madhyasth Darshan's homonym *adhyasa* in the animal order — species-traditional inertial-impression accepted from gestation (§1.5; SB, pp. 62–63) — which names conduct-pattern inheritance, not ontological superimposition on Brahman.
3. **Mithya (Ontological Status of Dependent Appearance)**
   - Advaita introduces *mithya* (strictly *sad-asad-anirvacaniya* — neither absolutely real nor sheer nothing) to describe the world. The three-tier scheme is classically grounded in CU 6.2.1–6.2.2 with Śaṅkara's bhāṣya and the clay-pot illustration of *satkaryavāda* (VC, v. 251; §§2.3–2.4). Madhyasth Darshan rejects any intermediate ontological status: everything that exists is real, perpetual, and indestructible.
4. **Ishvara (Saguna Brahman / Governor)**
   - In Advaita, Ishvara is Brahman associated with *Maya* — operative cause of name-form manifestation, a *vyavahara*-level category sublated at *paramartha* (VC, v. 244), not a personal creator *ex nihilo*. Madhyasth Darshan rejects **Ishvara in this sense** — a cosmic governor who plans, acts as efficient cause, or dispenses grace. That is not the same as rejecting transcendence altogether: MVD's ninth Reality set includes **"God is omnipresent, deities are many"** (proposition 5; §1.12) —

God here names actionless Omnipresence (*satta*), while **deities are many** denies elevating personal deities to ultimate status. Orderliness (*vyavastha*) is self-regulation (*swatah-saspurt*) inherent in the co-existing orders, as stated in §1.7; *Satta* remains entirely actionless (*kriya-shunya*).

5. **Kaivalya / Recognition of identity (as Ultimate Liberation)**
    - Advaita seeks **recognition of pre-existing identity with Brahman**, in which the illusion of separate individuality is dispelled (*jiva-brahma-aikya* — unity/identity, not merger). The identity formula *tat tvam asi* (CU 6.8.7) and BS 1.1.2 with Śaṅkara's bhāṣya state the classical doctrine; VC, vv. 244, 574 compress the same pedagogy. Madhyasth Darshan holds that individual *jeevan* units remain eternally distinct; the ultimate goal is **awakened coexistence (*jagriti*)**, where *jeevan* units remain active in harmonious relationships (*sambandh*) with other humans and the ecological orders.

The mapping attempt reveals fundamental difficulties. While surface-level analogues exist, the core ontological commitments are ultimately irreconcilable. Advaita is a world-subordinating non-dualism that views individuality and the universe as dependent appearances (*mithya*) to be transcended. In stark contrast, Madhyasth Darshan is a relational realism that affirms the eternal distinctness of sentient units and the perpetual reality of the world. Because of these profound differences, a true one-to-one mapping is impossible without distorting the foundational claims of either system.

5.8 Where the alliances fall

No single tradition wins every dispute. Three pairwise patterns clarify what each view shares with and denies to the others:

Madhyasth Darshan and Advaita against physicalism. Both refuse to treat existence as merely physicochemical matter. Consciousness, value, and the self are not exhaustively explained as brain-generated epiphenomena. Against reductive materialism, both hold that something more than bare mechanism is required — though they disagree sharply on what that "more" is.

Madhyasth Darshan and science against Advaita. Both treat the world as real and worth studying. Matter, bodies, relationships, and ecological order are not finally *mithya* or preparatory illusion. Against world-negating non-dualism, both insist that nature and society have final weight — though science does not affirm Omnipresence or immortal *jeevan*.

Advaita and science against Madhyasth Darshan. Both set a high bar for claims that exceed public evidence. Advaita holds that separate individuality was never ultimately real (VC, v. 574); science treats the self as a biological process that ceases at **brain death** (§4.1). Against Madhyasth Darshan's eternal distinct sentient units, both deny — on different grounds — that an immortal individual self is established.

Each pair agrees on something the third denies. Comparative clarity depends on naming which question is at stake: matter-only reduction, world-reality, or individual immortality.

6. Critical Review

6.1 Internal coherence of the Madhyasth Darshan position

Judged on its own definitions — not as proof against rivals — the ontology hangs together. Coexistence, real units, and beginninglessness form one picture without separate doctrines for each question (§5.1 maps the cross-tradition contrast). "Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual" preserves the reality of nature, society, relationship, and ethical responsibility rather than sublating the world. Consciousness, value, and selfhood are not treated as mere byproducts of body-chemistry. If existence is coexistence, human fulfilment must be evidenced as coexistence in behavior, not merely believed. "Nothing existent is annihilated" gives internal coherence to *vastu* persisting through *roop*-change, bodily death as configuration-shift, and development within beginningless coexistence — though post-death continuity of *this jeevan* is a further metaphysical commitment, not a theorem of quantity conservation alone (§1.12, §6.2.4).

These are strengths **within** the system's premises. They do not by themselves establish those premises against Advaita or physicalism (see §6.2–§6.6).

6.2 Open problems for Madhyasth Darshan

The items below are numbered **6.2.1–6.2.10** for cross-reference. They group under internal coherence, evidence and science, and comparative philosophy.

6.2.1 The emergence of sentience

Madhyasth Darshan holds that an insentient atom, through development, reaches constitutional completeness and becomes sentient *jeevan* (SB, pp. 55, 59). That account uses threshold grammar — a quantitative stability producing a qualitative register of active sentience — which can sound like strong emergence. The darshan also borrows Strawson's anti-emergence principle against physicalism (§3.3). The darshan's resolution is **latency**: sentience is eternally present through coexistence in *satta* as *gyan* and is **actualized** at constitutional completeness, not created from nothing (SB, p. 59; §6.6). What remains open is the detailed physical mechanism of the Saturation-Reflector Model and whether latency can be stated in fully formal terms.

6.2.2 Mutual dependence and the Nagarjuna challenge

Madhyasth Darshan holds that inherent energy in units and manifestation of uniform energy as activity are inseparable through saturation — **mutual dependence for manifestation** (the reciprocal structure in SB p. 62 and MVD p. 40), not one-way physical supply (§1.2). Without unit activity (*basic impulsion*), uniform energy at the ground remains unmanifest; without saturation, there is no basic impulsion (SB, p. 62; MVD, p. 40). SB's identity-chain treats each link as "itself is," not as external push — yet the chain still binds ground and unit: forcefulness, impulsion, activity, and development are readable only through saturated units.

Nagarjuna’s critique of *svabhava* (intrinsic existence) is potentially the **most serious philosophical threat** to this system, because Madhyamaka asks whether anything that exists only through mutual dependence can exist **from its own side** at all.

What Madhyamaka presses. In the *Mulamadhyamakakarika*, Nagarjuna argues that what possesses *svabhava* would exist independently — not produced by causes, not dependent on conditions, not conceptually constructed. Dependent origination (*pratityasamutpada*) is the obverse: whatever arises dependently lacks such intrinsic nature and is **empty** (*shunya*) of *svabhava*. The critique is not merely that things have causes; it is that **dependence and intrinsic existence are incompatible**. Applied to Madhyasth Darshan: if *satta*‘s uniform energy is manifest only through unit-activity, and unit activeness is readable only through saturation in *satta*, a Madhyamaka reader may conclude that neither pole is independently real — precisely the reduction to dependent co-arising without enduring units that coexistential realism must resist. Beginninglessness does not automatically block that inference. Eternal co-dependence can still be co-dependence: what never began can still lack *svabhava* if its being is wholly relational.

Where the pressure lands in Madhyasth Darshan. The vulnerability is structural, not a single misquoted sentence. Saturation is the first relational layer of coexistence; *sambandh* among units is the second (§1.6). Every unit carries form, properties, **essential nature** (*svabhav*), and *dharma* (§1.3) — a definite signature that participates in orderliness. Conservation holds that *vastu* is not annihilated (§1.12). Immortal *jeevan* units are functionally indivisible individuals (§1.9–1.10). All of this speaks the language of **enduring particulars with natures**. Madhyamaka’s *svabhava* and Madhyasth Darshan’s *svabhav* are not the same technical term — the latter names order-specific essential nature, not Buddhist intrinsic existence — but the English collision is not harmless: a reader trained in Garfield’s or Westerhoff’s Madhyamaka will hear “inherent energy,” “essential nature,” and “indestructible unit” as claims of the very intrinsic status Nagarjuna targets.

The implicit Madhyasth reply — and its limits. The texts’ answer, never framed as a reply to Buddhism, rests on several commitments that must be distinguished:

Dependence type in the primary texts. The texts do not use the formula “dependence for manifestation versus dependence for existence,” but the distinction is anchored in what they assert. MVD p. 40 brackets the reciprocal revelation claim with eternal co-presence — “Nature is eternally present in absolute energy” — so matter is not said to arise when energy is revealed; units are already there *in* absolute energy while remaining reciprocally required for its appearance as activity. JV p. 18 states that there is “no provision in existence to separate units of nature from Omnipresence,” treating saturation as structurally provisioned rather than contingent mutual reliance. MVD p. 13’s Reality propositions — “the world is perpetual” (*jagat satat*), many *jeevan*-clouds, immortal *jeevan* — refuse demotion of units and world to mere conventional designation. These passages support reading SB p. 62 / MVD p. 40 reciprocity as dependence for **revelation**, not for ontological absence of either pole; they do not constitute an explicit reply to Nagarjuna.

1. **Co-eternal co-presence, not derivation.** *Satta* and units are "inseparably present" from the outset (SB, p. 48; MVD, p. 11, 40). Neither is produced from the other; neither is ontologically posterior. Mutual dependence for **manifestation** is not temporal emergence from non-being — the pattern §1.12 denies for existence as a whole.

2. **Asymmetric roles within inseparability.** Omnipresence is *sthitipurn* (state-complete): non-transforming, actionless, without motion or pressure (SB, pp. 50, 68–69). Nature saturated in it is *sthitishil* (state-dynamic): units whose activity constitutes all change. *Satta* is *mahakaran* — supreme cause in the **sustaining** sense, not the efficient trigger of particular change (§1.4). The poles are mutually dependent for how energy appears, but not interchangeable: one is formless ground, the other is formful activity.

3. **Countably many reals, not mode-monism.** MVD's second Reality proposition pairs omnipresent Brahma with **many** *jeevan*-clouds (MVD, p. 13). Units are bounded, countable, and saturated — not modes of a single substance expressing one nature (contrast Spinoza, §3.6.2). Madhyasth Darshan's plural *ikai* are ontological partners of *satta*, not appearances on a one-sided ground.

4. **Definite relationships and value.** Units stand in *sambandh* with predetermined expectations toward completeness (MVD, p. 62). Recognition, fulfilment, and essentiality-as-value (§1.6) treat nature as a structured moral-ontological order, not a flux of dependently arisen events with no final weight.

Taken together, these commitments sketch a **coexistential realism**: ground and units are eternally co-present, asymmetrically related, plural, and law-governed. That is not Advaita's world-negating non-dualism and not Buddhist process reduction — but whether it survives Madhyamaka is a separate question. A Madhyamaka philosopher can accept co-eternality and asymmetry yet still ask: if each pole lacks manifestation without the other, what **positive ontological status** remains beyond relational role? Madhyasth Darshan answers "real coexistence" — *saha-astitva* as beingness and indestructibility — but has not yet shown that this answer meets the *svabhava* argument on its own terms.

Anatta as the sharper flank. Saturation mutual dependence threatens the **ground–unit structure**. Buddhist **anatta** threatens the **individual self** more directly (§5.4). If what we call *jeevan* is a dependently assembled, impermanent aggregate, constitutional completeness and post-death continuity (§§1.10–1.12, §6.2.4) fail regardless of how saturation is parsed. Madhyasth Darshan holds that *jeevan* is a real, immortal, constitutionally complete atom — not a conventional designation for changing aggregates. The Madhyamaka challenge and the anatta challenge converge on immortal individuality but diverge in mechanism: one attacks intrinsic existence through dependence, the other through diachronic decomposition. A full response to §6.2.2 must address **both**.

Pressure	Madhyamaka question	Madhyasth Darshan implicit answer	Still open
Saturation	Can ground and unit be real if each manifests only through the other?	Co-eternal co-presence; asymmetric sustaining vs active roles	Whether co-eternal mutual dependence avoids emptiness of *svabhava*
Unit signature	Are form, *svabhav*, and *dharma* intrinsic natures?	Order-specific essential nature in mutuality, not isolated substance	Terminological and philosophical bridge to Buddhist *svabhava*
Jeevan	Is there an enduring self?	Functionally indivisible, constitutionally immortal sentient atom	Anatta tradition denies what MD asserts without shared proof
Conservation	Does persistence entail intrinsic identity?	*Vastu* conserved through *roop*-change; *jeevan* continuity across bodies	Category error risk (§6.2.4) if conservation is read as entity-proof

Lines a future defense would need to develop. None of the following is established in the primary texts as an explicit anti-Madhyamaka argument; they are the most promising directions for rigorous work:

- **Dependence type.** Distinguish dependence for **manifestation** (how uniform energy and activity appear together) from dependence for **existence** (whether a pole could be absent). Madhyasth Darshan appears to deny the second while asserting the first — with MVD p. 40's bracketing clause, JV p. 18 on non-separability, and MVD p. 13 on world-perpetuity and plural *jeevan* as the primary textual hooks. A formal account must still show that distinction is principled, not verbal, to Madhyamaka standards.
- **Two-level realism without world-negation.** Advaita uses *vyavahara* robustness while sublating at *paramartha* (§2.3). Madhyasth Darshan refuses that sublation — *jagat satat* (MVD, p. 13). A Madhyamaka-informed defense cannot simply borrow Advaita's two truths; it must explain how units retain **final** weight while lacking Buddhist *svabhava*, or else revise the ontology.
- **Law of coexistence vs bare co-arising.** The texts treat development, awakening, and relationship-recognition as **provisioned and definite** (MVD, pp. 5, 61, 77) — not arbitrary reconfiguration. If emptiness is compatible with conventional order, Madhyasth Darshan needs to show its laws are the conventional structure Madhyamaka can accept **without** demoting units to mere designation — or argue that Madhyamaka's conventional level is too thin for MD's relational realism.
- **Individual immortality.** Functional indivisibility of *gathanpurna parmanu* (§1.9) is the main reply to aggregate reduction. That case must be made independently of saturation prose and tested against Buddhist analyses of personhood.

Until those lines are developed, Nagarjuna's challenge belongs at the **center** of the open-problems list. Mutual dependence in §1.2 is not a decorative metaphor; it is the hinge on which coexistential realism meets Madhyamaka emptiness. Formal work on latency and the law of coexistence (§6.6) cannot be complete without this engagement. Madhyasth Darshan's implicit reply rests on co-eternal asymmetric co-presence and plural enduring units — not on denying mutual dependence outright — yet that reply remains an open defense, not a settled answer to Madhyamaka on its own terms.

6.2.3 *Satta–ikai* relation and circular causality

§§1.2–1.4 state mutual dependence and the single effort–motion–result triad with its sentient unfolding in prose; what remains is formalization — not discovery of whether the texts assert them. Unit cardinality is read as practical uncountability throughout (§1.5). What remains to formalize here is mutual dependence, the effort–motion–result triad, and circular causality in prose — not a plurality whose scale is mathematically infinite.

6.2.4 Mereology, identity, conservation inference, and rebirth

Category error first: JV p. 20 is the system's most empirically exposed inference — post-death survival and re-association of *jeevan* from "nothing is annihilated." From the standpoint of modern science, this inference conflates **conservation of quantity** with **conservation of structure (or entity)**: physics conserves mass-energy and charge, but not specific configurations or functional identities. Thermodynamic and field-theoretic conservation alone do not guarantee the immortality of a structured unit like *jeevan* unless *gathanpurnata* is already assumed as a separate metaphysical axiom. §1.12 separates coexistence conservation from *jeevan* persistence and rebirth; the friction with particle physics is whether a **particular composite configuration** — once constitutionally complete — is immune to decay or decomposition, when composite bound states in physics are not absolutely indestructible. That is the weakest inferential link for post-death survival and transmigration and should be weighed accordingly.

The *gathanpurna parmanu* at issue is **not** an elementary particle in the sense of modern physics. MVD treats every atom as a **composite**: its kind, state, and measure are fixed by the number of particles in its nucleus and its orbiting dependent particles (MVD, p. 42); constitutional completeness is reached when the required number of such particles is integrated into a stable compound configuration (SB, pp. 55, 59; §1.9). Madhyasth Darshan reads *jeevan*'s "indivisibility" as **functional** — a self-maintaining constitution that does not spontaneously lose completeness — not as the claim that *jeevan* has no parts (§1.10). Identity is continuity of that constitution across death and re-association (§1.10–1.12).

6.2.5 *Jeevan*–body interaction

If *jeevan* is a constitutionally complete atom that **drives** the body, physicalist readers face an interaction problem as old as Descartes. Either *jeevan* exerts physical force on neural and muscular tissue — in which case the interaction should be measurable in principle, and constitutional completeness should be operationalizable, contradicting §6.2.7 — or it does not exert physical force, in which case "drives" must name a non-mechanical mode of influence that the texts have not specified.

What the primary texts do say. Humans are a **joint form** of *jeevan* and body; the body is medium and instrument, not the sentient self (§1.10; MVD p. 13). MVD's four-level causal hierarchy places *atma* within *jeevan* as **causal** level — gross body, subtle atoms, causal *atma*, supreme cause *satta* (MVD, pp. 288–289) — so intention is not modeled as a separate substance pushing neurons from outside. MVD p. 115 describes vibrational motion on the brain from the cognitive organs leading to knowledge-unfolding (§1.11) — a pathway description within the human as joint form, not a proof of physical causal closure.

What the primary texts do not settle. Whether *jeevan*'s "driving" **violates physical causal closure** or names **non-mechanical influence within** the effort–motion–result activity already attributed to the human as joint form. No passage in this study's corpus commits to measurable extra physical force **or** to epiphenomenal accompaniment. The system **appears** to take the second horn in spirit — hierarchical unit-causation within coexistence, not Cartesian push — but closure relative to modern physics remains **open in the primary sources**, not only in the comparative account here.

The darshan often says *jeevan* "works through" the body without settling closure; the horn it seems to intend is non-mechanical influence within unit-causation, not Cartesian push. Full treatment belongs in the planned *Philosophy-Of-Mind-And-Jeevan* study.

6.2.6 Provisioned structure vs deluded default

§1.10.1 states the ontological frame: six provisioned perspectives, humane refuge under *nyaya–dharma–satya*, and the distinct evaluative registers of conduct, thought, and realisation (MVD, pp. 66–67, 126–127, 137). What remains is fuller treatment at the intersection of ontology and lived conduct — especially how subordination of *priya–hita–labh* under the humane triad becomes reorganization rather than abandonment (Ethics-And-Morals-In-Human-Beings §3.2).

6.2.7 Constitutional completeness is not operational

Central to the ontology but not presently measurable in physics or chemistry.

6.2.8 Evidence standard vs. science

Realization and behavior are cited; science requires public testability. What would count as evidence for *jeevan* beyond the hard-problem explanatory gap? §6.4 addresses this. An explanatory gap in the hard problem is not by itself an existence proof for *jeevan*; physicalists treat it as philosophically non-decisive while Madhyasth Darshan reads it as ontological incompleteness in matter-only accounts (§3.2, §6.2.1). Comparisons with physics use **consonant with**, **parallel to**, or **in tension with** — not "supported by" unless the evidence warrants it; conceptual resonance with beginningless cosmological models is not proof of perpetual nature (*satat*) (§4.3). Claims about individual immortality and constitutional completeness remain distinct metaphysical assertions beyond what current science validates.

6.2.9 "Knowledge but not knower"

Madhyasth Darshan calls Omnipresence *gyan* while denying it the activity of knowing; active *gyan udghatan* belongs only to awakened *jeevan* (§1.11). The positive ontological account of *gyan* as intelligibility-ground is §1.11; comparative work must not collapse that ground into Advaita's *chit* (Brahman as awareness itself) — a misreading the English translation's "Consciousness" label encourages (Editorial Notes). Epistemic machinery (*gyan-vivek-vigyan*, evidence) belongs in Knowledge, Knower, and Known.

6.2.10 The nature of time

This paper states Madhyasth Darshan's core claim — *kaal* as duration of activity, not independent substance; timeless *satta*; numerical reckoning within existence. Past/present/future structure, JVD on "activity eternally present," and comparison with Advaita *trikaal* language, McTaggart, eternalism/presentism, and spacetime physics are developed in *Nature-Of-Time*; residual open problems remain in that study's §6.

6.3 Strengths and Limits of Advaita

Advaita has a powerful answer to non-being (existence cannot arise from non-existence, CU 6.2.2) and a rigorous first-person method — DDV's seer-seen discrimination and MU's three-state analysis (§§2.1–2.6). Its ontology is also **parsimonious**: one partless Brahman, without a second ground, without plural immortal substances, without a separate cosmic power of illusion standing alongside the absolute. Against Madhyasth Darshan's coexistence of *satta*, countless *ikai*, definite *sambandh*, and latency at *gathanpurnata*, Advaita compresses existence into a single subject whose empirical multiplicity is finally sublated.

Its limit, from the Madhyasth perspective, is that making the world *mithya* at *paramartha* makes it harder to ground the **final** ontological weight of relationships, nature, society, and conduct — even though *vyavahara* is robust, shared, and law-governed (§2.3). Nagraj's native objection, framed against the Vedanta he inherited, presses this point from origination:

> **"According to Vedanta knowledge, only Brahma is the truth, and this world is an illusion ('Brahma satya, jagat mithya'). However, jeeva and jagat are said to have originated from Brahma."**
> *- MVD, The Alternative*
>
> **"How can the jeeva and jagat, which originated from the Truth, Knowledge, and Infinite Brahma, be an illusion?"**
> *- MVD, The Alternative*

Madhyasth Darshan's counter-slogan — *Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual* (MVD, p. 13; §1.12) — is not mere rhetoric. If *jeeva* and *jagat* arise from Sat-Chit-Ananda Brahman through *satkaryavada*, treating them as finally *mithya* looks internally unstable: the effect would be less real than a cause whose nature is being, consciousness, and bliss. Advaita's reply is the three-tier distinction and *vivartavada*: name-form is dependently real at *vyavahara* and sublated only at *paramartha*; the clay-pot is not nothing, but its separateness from clay is (VC, v. 251; §§2.3–2.4). That reply is coherent **within** Advaita; Madhyasth Darshan denies that sublation is the last word on the world.

Advaita's fair reply to world-negation — ethics, *loka-sangraha*, and beginningless *vyavahara* — is substantial and is exposited in §2.9; it should not be dismissed in a sentence. The Madhyasth counter-reply is narrower but precise. Beginningless *vyavahara* and robust ethics do not settle **final** ontological status. *Satat* (*perpetual*) names a world that retains full weight at the highest realization — relationships, nature, and *mulya* are not ultimately sublated (§5.7). An ontology that makes the world *mithya* at *paramartha* cannot give the world the same final weight coexistence gives it. This is a genuine disagreement about whether *vyavahara*'s robustness suffices for Madhyasth Darshan's standard of world-realness, not a defeat of Advaita on its own terms.

Madhyasth Darshan's exposed point against Advaita's parsimony is the **cost of plurality**: many immortal *jeevan* units, saturation mutual dependence, and tiered *gyan*/*chaitanya* buy relational realism at the price of ontological complexity Advaita refuses. Whether that cost is justified is part of what §6.2.2 and §6.5 leave open; Advaita's cost is world-subordination at the highest truth. Neither system is free of trade-offs.

6.4 Strengths and Limits of Modern Approaches

Modern approaches are strongest where Madhyasth Darshan is weakest: public evidence, empirical correction, cognitive modelling, precise mechanism. Self-model theory explains many features of embodied selfhood without an eternal *jeevan*; illusionism shows how a naturalist can reinterpret even the apparent obviousness of experience.

But modern philosophy is not unified. Chalmers and Nagel show experience resists reduction; Strawson shows some physicalists move toward panpsychism. It is inaccurate to say "modern philosophy has proved the self is only the brain." What modern philosophy **has** established is a high evidential bar: an explanatory gap is not an existence proof for *jeevan*.

What would count as evidence? Public science would require at minimum: (a) operational criteria for constitutional completeness independent of the philosophy; (b) reproducible markers distinguishing *jeevan*-mediated from brain-only activity; (c) independent evidence for post-death continuity of a sentient unit. Until then, Madhyasth Darshan's claims about immortal *jeevan* remain metaphysical assertions compatible with coexistence conservation but not validated by current science — while the hard problem shows physicalism's own exposed point (§3.2).

6.4.3 Physicalism's strongest reply: predictive processing

Physicalism's most developed recent reply to ontology-of-self challenges is **predictive processing** and **active inference** — exposited in §4.1 with the scientific evidence standard in §4.7. That reply deserves the same seriousness as Advaita's *loka-sangraha* defense in §6.3: it meets Madhyasth Darshan partway on embodiment, circular causation, and the reality of regulation in lived experience, and it is a harder opponent than bare eliminativism because it does not treat first-person structure as a mistake to explain away.

The Madhyasth counter-reply is narrower. Predictive models explain **how** a body self-regulates and represents its situation; they do not settle **whether** the regulator is only neural tissue or a distinct constitutionally complete unit working through the brain. Latency holds that sentience is actualized from coexistential ground at *gathanpurnata*, not generated as a new experiential ingredient from dead matter (§6.6). Until public criteria distinguish those ontologies, the dispute remains at the incommensurability boundary (§6.5) — not settled by predictive accuracy alone.

6.5 Epistemology: partially incommensurable criteria

The three systems do not merely give different answers; they use different criteria for what counts as knowing:

Tradition	Method	Adequate for
Madhyasth Darshan	Study, realization, behavior, experiment	Coexistence as lived evidence; conduct as proof of understanding
Advaita	Scripture, reasoning, contemplative discrimination (DDV, VC)	Self as Brahman; sublation of *mithya*
Physicalism	Observation, modelling, public evidence	Mechanism, prediction, third-person confirmation

To that extent they are **partially incommensurable** — no single neutral tribunal settles them. The study tests each tradition for internal consistency, fit with public knowledge, and responsible distinction of posits from bare assertion. The epistemic standards of realization as proof are examined in Knowledge, Knower, and Known.

6.6 Latency and the Saturation-Reflector Model

The Saturation-Reflector Model states how ever-present *gyan* in *satta* reaches active sentience (*chaitanya*) at constitutional completeness without strong emergence from dead matter (§§1.2, 1.9–1.10).

Madhyasth Darshan does **not** solve the hard problem of consciousness in the physicalist's sense. Sentience is eternally present in coexistence and **actualized** at constitutional completeness rather than produced from non-experience; the **Saturation-Reflector Model** is the darshan's central statement of that reading — but it **relocates** the problem rather than discharging it. Instead of asking why experience arises from wholly non-experiential matter, the system now owes two further questions: **(a)** why a constitutionally stable atom-configuration channels ever-present *gyan* into active *chaitanya* rather than remaining at the orderliness tier only (**selection**), and **(b)** what makes *satta* as *gyan* the experiential ground at all (**grounding**). Latency converts an emergence problem into a selection problem and a grounding problem; neither is settled here.

In analytical prose the study uses **mediating configuration** for the stable atom-structure at constitutional completeness; the source texts call it a **reflector** (*pratibimba* register in SB's saturation language). The English word is retained where the texts use it; it should not be read as optical bounce.

Textual basis for latency

SB p. 59: all atom types, including constitutionally complete ones, are "eternally present through the natural law of coexistence." Sentience is not created at completeness; it is actualized. SB p. 55: at completeness, particle count is fixed; change is qualitative without quantitative addition — not the arrival of a new experiential ingredient from non-experience.

Selectivity: why only *gathanpurna parmanu*?

Satta is all-pervasive; every unit is saturated. Pervasiveness does not entail universal **active** sentience. Saturation provisions inherent orderliness and energy in all units (SB, pp. 57, 69; §1.2); insentient units exhibit radiance and projection only. Active *chaitanya* appears when a constitutionally **stable** configuration — fixed particle count, self-maintaining completeness, inexhaustible force at the sentient threshold (SB, pp. 55, 59) — acts as the **mediating configuration** through which ever-present *gyan* reaches the knowing register.

The texts tie selectivity to **constitutional stability** — functional indivisibility and qualitative change without further quantitative addition — not to integration (IIT's Φ), metabolic closure alone (autopoiesis), or mere compositional size. The principled reason, within the darshan, is developmental: sentience is the **evidence** of constitutional completeness at the atomic threshold of Development Progression through the physicochemical complex (MVD, p. 76; SB, p. 59), not an independent property bolted onto matter. That is textually grounded but **not independently defended** against rivals who tie consciousness to information integration, biological self-production, or neural dynamics. A skeptical reader can accept saturation and still ask why particle-count stability is the sentience-relevant threshold rather than some other structural invariant. Comparative threshold accounts are tabulated below; what Madhyasth Darshan adds is latency in *satta*, not a third-person metric.

Answering the physicalist "emergence" objection

Digestion, weak emergence, IIT, and self-models share **threshold grammar** with *gathanpurnata* — potential organized one way, a qualitative register appears at a structural condition. Latency-at-a-threshold is structurally close to what IIT and weak emergence do; the disanalogy is what the threshold **actualizes**:

Rival account	What the threshold does	Experiential ground
Digestion / weak emergence	New function from chemistry	None; organization only
Self-model / predictive processing	Regulative model from neural dynamics	None; representation only
IIT	Consciousness from integrated information (Φ)	Experience tied to information structure
Saturation-Reflector (MD)	Active *chaitanya* from ever-present *gyan* in *satta*	Coexistential intelligibility-ground; latency

Madhyasth Darshan therefore does not treat sentience as strong emergence from dead matter. It treats sentience as **latency actualized** through a mediating configuration — consistent with Strawson's anti-emergence principle (§3.3) while restricting active sentience to constitutionally complete atoms, not every particle. Strawson's combination problem (§3.3) presses panpsychism; Madhyasth Darshan's reply is that *jeevan* is already one constitutionally complete unit, not an assembly of micro-minds — but that reply still leaves the threshold itself as the locus of unresolved selection and grounding.

Madhyasth Darshan and panpsychism share a deeper **grounding commitment**: experientiality — here as *gyan* / intelligibility-ground in *satta* — is primitive, not derived from wholly non-experiential matter. They **differ in distribution**: not every particle is a subject; only *gathanpurna parmanu* actualizes active *chaitanya*. The combination-problem escape in §3.3 is therefore **scope-relative**, not a discharge of the grounding posit. A physicalist can still read latency as panpsychism with selective actualization — proto-experience in *satta* rather than in particles, but experientiality-as-fundamental nonetheless.

Self-model and predictive-processing theories explain hierarchical regulation; they do not by themselves refute latency, because latency does not deny embodied regulation — it locates the sentient **unit** that works through the body.

What remains open

The model is a metaphysical framework, not a detailed physical mechanism. It does not answer physicalism's demand for third-person public evidence (§6.4), nor does it reconcile the claimed constitutional immunity of the composite *gathanpurna parmanu* with modern particle physics — where composite bound states decay rather than elementary particles being indestructible (§6.2.4). The hard problem is **asserted away** only in the weak sense that latency denies experience-from-nothing; it is **not solved** in the strong sense until selection and grounding are independently motivated and the Nagarjuna challenge (§6.2.2) is answered. Formalizing that reading within the law of coexistence — and defending it against Nagarjuna's *svabhava* critique — is the most promising route for later rigorous work.

7. Conclusion

Madhyasth Darshan answers the framing questions through a single ontological picture: eternally present **coexistence** (*saha-astitva*) of formless Omnipresence (*satta*) and countless **units** (*ikai*), beginningless and neither made from the other. Saturation binds ground to units; *sambandh*, complementarity, and value-fulfilment bind units to one another; complementary units compose into tiered assemblies from particles through societies (§1.5). What exists does not begin from non-existence (*abhava*); bodies and configurations do, while *vastu* persists through transformation. Time (*kaal*) is the duration of unit-activity, not an independent cosmic container (§1.6). Causation is circular and order-specific: *satta* is *mahakaran* — sustaining ground, not efficient trigger — and units work change through effort–motion–result (*shram–gati–parinam*), read in sentient nature toward constitutional, activity, and conduct completeness (§§1.6–1.9). Sentience belongs to the constitutionally complete atom (*gathanpurna parmanu*), actualised from coexistential ground rather than produced from dead matter (§6.6).

> **"Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual."**
> *- MVD, p. 13*

That formulation marks what is distinctive in comparative terms. Against **physicalism**, Madhyasth Darshan refuses matter-only reduction: consciousness, value, selfhood, and ethical relation are not exhaustively explained as brain-generated epiphenomena, yet the world of units remains fully real for study and responsibility — not a second-class appearance. Against **Advaita**, it refuses world-negation at the highest level: the perpetual world (*jagat satat*), distinct immortal *jeevan* units, and ontologically real relationships and values (*mulya*) retain final weight; coexistence is not compressed into a single subject whose empirical multiplicity is finally *mithya*. Against both, it holds a **relational realism**: Brahma is real, the world is real, and their inseparable presentness is coexistence — with ontology tied to conduct, so that understanding is fulfilled when coexistence becomes clear in one's own seeing and evident in humane living, responsible work, and experiment. The pairwise patterns in §5.8 show where each tradition agrees and diverges on these stakes; the critical review in §6 examines what remains open within and against that position.

Editorial Notes

Translation and editorial conventions (*satta*)

The source texts' primary English term for the all-pervasive, formless reality (*satta*) is **Omnipotence**; *vyapak* ("all-pervasive") is rendered "Omnipresence" in the English translation. The English translation alternates **Omnipotence** and **Omnipresence** for the same *satta*; Hindi *satta* is the constant behind both. To avoid the theistic connotations of "Omnipotence," the study uses **"Omnipresence"** as its running English term in analytical prose. Block quotes preserve whichever word the translation prints. Where Hindi *shunya* appears, the translation renders it **Space** — void/emptiness (actionless, formless), not physical *akasha*.

"Consciousness" in SB p. 48

The English translation lists several names for the pervasive reality (*Satta* / *Vyapak*): Uniform Energy, Space (*akasha*), Knowledge (*gyan*), Consciousness, Omnipresence, Eternity, God, and Absolute Energy. In SB p. 48, the parenthetical "(consciousness)" labels the all-pervasive reality, not a personal knowing mind. Sentience as the activity of a knower (*chaitanya*) is the status of *jeevan* (the sentient unit), not of Omnipresence (*satta*) itself. This distinction is essential; the comparative risk of collapsing *satta*-as-*gyan* into Advaita's *chit* is addressed in §1.11 and §6.2.9.

Naming tensions for *satta*

The source gives *satta* multiple English names. Several generate internal tensions if treated as interchangeable:

Name	Tension
Knowledge / Consciousness	Implies cognition — yet *satta* is denied as knower (§1.11).
Space / *Shunya*	Void/emptiness vs. fullness of energy; *shunya* is rendered "Space" in the English translation, not physical *akasha*.
God	Personhood vs. actionless, non-willing *satta*.
Absolute Energy	Dynamism vs. *kriya-shunya* (actionless).
Uniform Energy, Eternity	Listed alongside the names above; no single English label captures all aspects.

The source does not fully settle how these names cohere as one reality.

Madhyasth Darshan *svabhav* and Buddhist *svabhava*

Anglophone readers trained on Madhyamaka will hear Madhyasth Darshan's **essential nature** (*svabhav*) and hear Buddhist **intrinsic existence** (*svabhava*) — the same English stem, different technical terms. That homonym does real damage: "inherent energy," "essential nature," and "indestructible unit" can sound like precisely the intrinsic status Nagarjuna targets (§6.2.2).

In Madhyasth Darshan, *svabhav* names **order-specific essential nature** — how a unit's properties participate in mutuality and maintain balance among the four orders (§1.2). In Madhyamaka, *svabhava* names existence **from its own side**, incompatible with dependent origination. Read the essential-nature table in §1.2 with that distinction in mind; the Madhyamaka engagement belongs in §6.2.2, not in a casual identification of the two terms.

Advaita: *mithya* and *sad-asad-anirvacaniya*

The *mithya* doctrine and Advaita's three-tier framework (*pratibhasika*, *vyavahara*, *paramartha*) are related but distinct tools; §2 keeps them apart. The compound *sad-asad-anirvacaniya* is a post-Shankara systematic term (Vimuktatman, Vivarana school); Shankara uses "neither sat nor asat" language without that compound.

Advaita: *Vivekachudamani* as source

This study cites the *Vivekachudamani* (VC) heavily for accessible verse formulations of discrimination, ethics, and liberation. VC is a devotional *prakriya* (method) text traditionally attributed to Shankara; modern scholarship treats that authorship as uncertain. The Upanishads, *Mandukya*, and DDV supply the exegetical core; VC supplies pedagogical compression. Claims tied to VC should be read as standard Advaita teaching in that genre, not as a substitute for Brahma Sutra commentary on disputed points.

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- **CU** — *Chandogya Upanishad*. Cited: Existence alone, one without a second (6.2.1–6.2.2), with Shankara's commentary; clay and name-form (6.1.4) (§§2.1, 2.4).
- **MU** — *Mandukya Upanishad*. Cited: three states of consciousness (*avastha-traya*), vv. 3–7 (§2.2).
- **BG** — *Bhagavad Gita*, Shankara's commentary (Swami Gambhirananda). Cited: knower of the field (13.1–13.2) (§2.6); *loka-sangraha* and ordained duty (3.8) (§2.9).
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